

A COLLECTION OF
KACHÁRI
FOLK-TALES
AND RHYMES



J. D. ANDERSON
1895

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THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK OF A COLLECTION OF KACHÁRI FOLK-TALES AND RHYMES

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK A COLLECTION
OF KACHÁRI FOLK-TALES AND RHYMES ***

A
COLLECTION
OF
KACHÁRI FOLK-TALES AND RHYMES,
INTENDED AS A SUPPLEMENT TO
REVEREND S. ENDLE'S
KACHÁRI GRAMMAR.

BY
J. D. ANDERSON,
INDIAN CIVIL SERVICE.



SHILLONG :
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TRANSLITERATION.

I am sorry to find that in transcribing I have wandered away from Mr. Endle's system of marking the values of the vowels. But the differences are, in essence, very small.

The circumflex accent indicates a long vowel.

“â” is as in Mr. Endle's Grammar.

“û” is the guttural “u” printed in Mr. Endle's Grammar as “ũ.”

J. D. A.

PREFACE.

This little collection of Kachári folk-stories and rhymes is intended as a supplement to the Reverend Mr. Endle's Grammar of the language, and as a reading-book for those who have acquired an elementary knowledge of Kachári. I have added a rough translation, thinking that these specimens of the folk-lore of a very simple and primitive people may be of interest to some who do not care to learn Kachári, and that it may stimulate others to make fuller and more successful excursions into an unexplored field. These stories were collected during a tour of only six weeks' duration in the Kachári mauzas of Mangaldai, and cost only the effort of taking down the tales as they were dictated. Not only the Kacháris, but the other hill tribes of Assam have doubtless their stores of folk legends which have never been exploited; and it pleases me to hope that others may find it as pleasant as I have found it, to collect these fictions of the savage mind over the camp fire. The text of the stories suggests a problem which it may amuse some one with better opportunities or more perseverance than myself to solve. It will be noticed that while the words are for the most part Kachári words, the syntax is curiously like the Assamese syntax. As an instance of this I have taken down (see page 1) an accused person's statement in both Assamese and Kachári. The Kachári version is, literally, a word-for-word translation of the Assamese. I can think of no other two languages in which it would be possible to translate a long statement word for word out of one into the other and yet be idiomatic. The most characteristic idioms are exactly reproduced. The Assamese says *mor bapáy*, but *tor báper*. The Kachári similarly says *Ângnî âfâ*, but *nangnî namfâ*. The Assamese says *e dâl láthi*; the Kachári translates *gongse lauthi*. The Assamese says *gai-pelay kalon*; the Kachári *khithâ-hùi-man*. And many more instances will occur to any one with a knowledge of Assamese who reads these stories. Briefly, it may be said that Kachári, as it is spoken in Darrang, has a vocabulary mostly of the Bodo type, though it contains many words borrowed from the Assamese. Its syntax, on the other hand, is nearly identical with the Assamese, almost the only exception being the use of the agglutinate verb

(see page 26 of Mr. Endle's Grammar). Even the agglutinate verb is more or less reproduced in Assamese in the use of such expressions as *gai pelay*. Now it is quite possible that the Kacháris, from long association with their Hindu neighbours, have learnt their syntax, while retaining their own vocabulary. A more tempting theory is that Assamese and Kachári are both survivals of the vanished speech of the great Koch race, who, we know, ruled where Assamese and Kachári are now spoken side by side; that Assamese has retained the Koch syntax, while it has adopted the Hindu vocabulary of Bengal; that Kachári has preserved both vocabulary and syntax. This theory, if it can be defended, would at last give Assamese a valid claim to be considered a separate tongue, and not a mere dialect of Bengali. It would also give an explanation of the vexed question of the origin of the word Kachári. *Ârúi* is a common patronymic in the Kachári speech. As Mr. Gait has noted in his Census Report, the Kacháris have totemistic clans, calling themselves Bâg-ârúi, sons of the tiger, and so on. What more simple than that the Koch-ârúi are the sons of the Koches? So far, the problem is one of mere guesswork and theory. But there are other branches of the Bodo tongue in the Tipperah and Gáro Hills and in North Cachar, where men of the Bodo race do not come into contact with Assamese. Do the same idioms and the same syntax exist there? If not, they were probably borrowed from Hindu sources. If they do, it seems probable that these idioms and this syntax have survived not only in them, but in the Hinduised Assamese.

I had intended to draw up a list of the agglutinate verbs found in this little collection of stories to supplement that given at page 26 of Mr. Endle's Grammar. But anyone interested in the subject will find them for himself in the stories, and will learn more easily from the context than from any vocabulary what the precise shades of meaning of the interpolated particles are. They are a very curious and interesting feature of the language, and are probably found in richer abundance where the well of Bodo undefiled has not been contaminated by a mixture with other tongues.

I must not conclude without offering my hearty thanks to the Reverend Mr. Endle for his advice and help in collecting these stories, and to Samson, my tutor, who was in truth "the only begetter of these ensuing" fictions. He told

me most of them and corrected all. I have no doubt he has many other primitive legends, if any one will take the trouble to write them down.

J. D. ANDERSON.

The 21st September 1894.

P.S.—There can be no doubt that the Kachári of Darrang is greatly influenced by the surrounding Assamese, though, even now, many Kacháris, and especially women, do not speak Assamese at all. There is an anecdote among the Kacháris showing the inconveniences of the bilingual state. A Kachári lad married an Assamese girl, and going to his mother-in-law's house was given food. His hospitable mother-in-law cried to him "Khâ! Khâ!" so he bound her hand and foot. Then she laughed, seeing that he supposed her to be talking Kachári. So she said to him (in Kachári) "Zâ! Zâ!" on which he went away. I am afraid the Kachári syntax is borrowed from Assamese.

KACHÁRI FOLK-TALES AND RHYMES.

An accused person's statement in Assamese and Kachári.

Question.— Tumi ki kaba khujá?
Nang mâ bungnú nâmaidang?

Answer.— Mangalbár diná may ishkulalai gaichhilon. Âmár parikshár din haichhile.
Mangalbár diná âng ishkulau thângdangman. Zangnî parikhâ-nî din zâdangman.
Mástore ámare ghar âhibalai du bájit chuti dile. Gharat áhi, khai-dai-kari,
Mâstorâ zangfûrkhô nâ fainû-lâgi du bâzit chuti hûnai. Nâ fainânai, zâui lûngûi,
Nandir tát paribalai galon. Nandiye mot-kai beshi pare. Tin bájit may
Nandi-nî-au sùlungnú lâgi thângnaise. Nandi âng-nùkhri sùlung-sî-nù. Tini baziau âng
gaichhilon. Tát derh ghanta parichhon. Sâre chári bájit pari thakár pará mar
thângnai. Bean gphantâ-se-khaise sùlungnai. Ghantâ brûi-khaise sulungbai thânai-au ângnî
Paramesvari bhanir mát sunilon; “Maharânir dohai, Kampanir dohai, mar
Paramesvari âgûi-nî mâthù khnânâise; “Mahârâni-nî dohai, Kampani-nî dohai, ângnî
garbbhabati baiek chulit dhariba ne pai.” E rakam buli sunáte
modom-au thânai âgûi-nî kheneau homnú manâ.” Be baidî bungnai khnânai-au
may ulai áhilon. Dekhon ji Kuntiye Gilásiye chulia-chuli-kai pariyáchhe,
âng onkhât-bù-naise. Nunaise Kunti-zang Gilâsi-zang kheneau hom-lai-nânai goglainânai dang,
áru Paramesvariye o Ilásiye. Mosai e dál rul ánipelai Gilásik erwai dile,
âru Paramesvari zang Ilâsi-zang. Mosaiâ rul gong-se lânânai Gilâsikhô sâgâ-hù-naise,
Kuntik ágar mári dharichhe. Bám háte Kuntir hátat dharichhe, hon hátat rulir
Khhunthikhô hom-khiup-naise. Âkhsîzang Khunti-nî âkhâiau homdang, âgdâ zang rul zang
ághát karichhe Kunti tatkhânât pari gaichhe. Tár sheshe Madhu áhichhe. Âhi Kuntik
bu dang Khhuntiâ obânù gaglai-nângnai. Bînî unau Madhu fainai. Fainânai Khuntikhô

chulit dhari e char mǎrichhe. May galon; gay pelay kalon: “Apo e sab kheneau homnânai sùbâ-se sùbânaise. Âng thângnaise; thângnânai khithânaise: “Brai befùr baṛ anyáy kathá. He ke janie tomár jiyar, e ke janie tomár jiyar. Tomár hāmâ khorâng. Be sâne-sùâbù nangnî fisâzù, be sâne-sùâbù nangnî fisâzù. Nangnî jiyar-hatak jì ne mǎrilá, mor bhani-hatak kio mǎrilá? Tomár jiyar-hatak o fisâzù-fùrkhô zi buâ-khùise, ângnî âgùi-fùr-khô mânù bunai? Nangnî fisâzù-fùr-khô bù mǎriba puá, mor bhanihatak o mǎriba puá. Âru ran bhángi diba puá.” E bu-nângauman, ângnî âgùi-fùr-khô bù bu-nângauman. Ârù nânglai-nai sefai-nângauman.” Erù buli kawáte mok bukate Bângâli-ghusâ¹ marile. He ghusá khai, may jijir-muá khithánai-au âng-khô zerbâ-i-au Bângâli-ghusâ saunaise. Be sau-zâ-nânai âng zingri-mutdâ khálon. Tenekwáte mar bapair mât sunichhon. Bapay-e kaichhe: “Mor maunaise. Ereaunù ângnî âtâr mâthù khnânaise. Âfâiâ khithâdang: ”Ângnî garbha-bati cháválik ne mǎribí.” Kawate Mosai ahile; mor bapaik modom-au thânai hingzausâkhô dâ bu.” Khithânai-au-nù Mosâiâ fainaise; ângnî âfâkhô e mǎr mǎrichhe. Bapáye bágari parichhe. Tár pichhat Madhue e mǎr mǎrichhe. Tár phongse budang. Âfâ gaglainaise. Bînî unau Madhuâ-bù phongse budang. Bînî pichhat Kámesvar bar bǎns e dal lai áhichhe. Mar manat sandeha hal. Mor bapáy buṛha unau Kámesvar wâ gedet gongse lâbodang. Ang gînaise. Ângnî âfâ brai mánu. E du mǎrate bapay kápi áchhe. Tenekwáte Kámesvare marichhe mânsùi. Be phong-ne bu-nai-au-nù âfâiâ maubai thâdang. Bebaidî-nù Kamesvarâ fongse e mǎr. Tenekwáte Madhu o e dal bǎns lai mariba-lai áhichhe. Pránar bhay dekhí, budang. Bebaidî-nù Madhu bù wâ gongse lânanai bunù faidang. Thoinu gînânai, jì thait sangrám haichhe, he thait e dál bǎns pálon. Mor bapaik mâre buli, zerau nânglaidangman, beau nù wâ-gon gongse man-nai. Ângnî âfâkhô bugan hannánai, mai o e bǎr Madhuk mǎrilon. Murat parichhe, na kót parichhe, mor gát yád ângbù fongse Madhukhô bunaise. khârâ-au-sù gaglai-khù, na mau-sù gaglai-khù, âng khithânù nai. Tetia Madhu mǎtit pari gaichhe. Mor bapaik may toli laichhon. Tenekwát mor bâiâ. Obânu Madhuâ hâ-i-au gaglainaise. Ângnî âfâkho âng dikhângnaise. Ereaunù ângnî kakai áhi paichhe. Kokai-e may-e ámár bapaik lai áhichhon, ârû Madhudale Madhuk âdâ sǎ fainaise. Âdâzang ângzang zang-nî âfâkhô lâbônaise, ârû Madhuni-frâ Madhukhô lai gaichhe. lângnaise.

Dùimâ dùisâ ni khorâng.

Sânùi brai burui man. Phâre unau
bîsur gothai brai-buruî zâlângbâ,
buruiâ zingâsînânai brainu
khithânâise “Brai, zangfûrhâ zî
dânai fisâfur dang, bîsûr mâ zânânai
thânggan?” Erui bungbâ braia mai
hu khâmnu lâgi Khubernîau
thângnânai, mai sobai bîsor ârû lai-
megong lâfâ megong bîfûr mânî-nî
bîgot-zului bînânai nâ-i-au
lâbônânai sânsnî sânzât lâmâiau ho
thânânai, nâ man-fai-nânai buruinù
khithanâise: “Ang gasenù bigot-
zului lâbobai.” Phâre nâ-i-au sâ-n-
sù thânânai, khet khâmnu lâgi sorai
fithâ-gundui lânânai hâ, nainù lâgi
thângnâise. Phâre gahâm hâ, dâtse
nai-ui frâbui fâtbrùi-thing-bù zurâ
khânânai dinnanai nâ fainâise. Unau
sânseni-khâli khodal sekhâ, bîfûr-
mâni lânânai thângnânai hâgrâ
eonânai ârû bî hâgrâtùrkhô saunânai
hâkhô mazâng khâmnaise. Bînîfrai,
sanzâ sanâp ârû sâ khùlâ fâtbrùi-
thing khulumnânai khonâ brùithing
phongse phongse zaunâise.

How the rivers were made.

Once upon a time there lived an old
man and an old woman. And when
they were quite old, the old woman
said to her husband “How shall
these our children get food when we
are gone?” So the old man travelled
afar to the great god Kuvera,²⁶ the
god of riches, and, taking from him
seedlings of paddy, pulse, mustard,
and gourds, journeyed for eight days
and so reached his home. And after
staying a couple of days, he set forth
to cultivate, taking dry food with
him. And first he marked out a piece
of rich land by placing boundaries
on all four sides of it, and so came
home. And again he set out another
day with hoe and axe, and cut and
burned the jungle, and cleaned the
soil, and after worshipping on each
side of his field—on the east and on
the west, on the north and on the
south—he struck one blow with his
hoe on each side.

Biaunù hâ gasenù mannaise. Phâre baidî baidî mai ârù fîfâng megon-thaigong boikhôbù fùnânai hùnaise. Phâre hâbâ zapbâ braiâ nâi-au thângnânai zirai nânai thânaise. Obâsù âzîbù dang khâlibù dang sânsê buruiâ mai nainù lâgi braikhô lùgù homnaise. Khintu braia bungnaise “Lâmâiau dùi gùiâ. Nanghâ dùi gâng-bâ âng maunîfrai hùnù?” Theobù bî brai-nî khorâng khnâsongâlâbâ embrâbrâ braikhô homnaikhai lâng-gnâng-naise. Phâre thânguì thânguì mainî hâ man-sî man-sî zâbâ, buruihâ dùi gângnânai brainù khithâbâ, braiâ bungnaise “Âng nangnù dùhùi-nù khithâ-dangman, nonggâ? lâmbâ-i au gùia hannânai? Theobù ângnî khorâng khnâ-i-âlâbâ fainânai ângkhô dukhu hùîù. Ereui bungbâ, buruiâ bungnaise. Dinî âng dùi man-lâng-âbâ, thoi-sî-gan. Nang âng-nù dùi hùnùânnggô.” Phâre unau braiâ mungbù upai mane zânânai, dùi namai-nâng-naise. Nâmaie nâmaie fukurimanse nubâ, bî buruinî megonkhô hî zang khânânai be fukuri-hâ-lâgi lângnaise. Ârù braiâ bungnaise “Nang be fukuri khô naiâlâbâ dùi lâng.” Khintu dùi lângbâ-rù mâbâ mâbâ dùi nî dau ârù hângsùfrâ birlai-bâ, bîkhô khnânânai, bîkhô nainù lubuinânai nainaise. Beaunù daufurnî gelenai

And when all was ready, the old man planted his seedlings of various sorts, and finally went home and rested. And so, as time went by, the old woman desired vehemently to see how the crops were getting on. But the old man said “There is no water on the road, and if you grow athirst, you will get no relief.” But she persisted and prevailed, and made her husband take her along. And as they went, and were now quite close to her husband’s field, behold, the old woman began to be very thirsty. And the old man, being enraged, cried “What did I tell you? There is no water, and yet you would come.” But she, being a woman, said “If you do not give me to drink, I shall die. So, water you must procure as best you can.” So the old man, seeing no other way, went to seek for water. And after long search, seeing a tank, he bound the old woman’s eyes with a cloth and dragged her to the water’s edge and said to her “Drink if you will, but look not upon the tank.” Now the ducks and other water fowls were playing in the water, and were making a merry noise, clacking and quacking. And, the old woman, being curious, like all her sex, peeped at them. And, seeing them at their play, she too desired to be

â-rù rong zâ-lainai nunânai bîhâbù
brai zang rong zâ-lainù mon zânâise.
Obâsù braiâ khâmâ, buruiâ âgârâ.
Phâre braiâ buruinî khorâng lânù
gnâng zânâise. Obâsù bîsùrhâ âji-
bù-thâiù khâli-bù-thâiù gâthâ gâthai
zânâise. Zâbâ, bîsùrkhô fisînù
hâekhai braiâ bîsùrkhô buruinî
khorângzang Hem-nî hâzô-au
lângnânai beaunù fukuri manse
khâmnânai baidî baidî nâ khâm-
nânai dùiauhogârnânai dinbù-naise.

Phâre unau Srî braiâ sùimâ fudrun
mâse lânânai, mùi sessâ â-rù
khusung nâmaibaie nâmaibaie dùì
gângsù dangman. Ereau-nù Srî braiâ
be fukuriau thâng-fnâng-naise.
Beaunù dùì nunânai lângnù
nâmaibâ, nâfrâ bîkhô raidaunaise.
“Afâ, nang bení dùì lângbâ,
zangfùrkhô gahâm khâmnânggan.”
Beaunù bî sùmai lânânai, dùìkhô
lângbâ, nâfrâ bungnaise. “Dâ nang
zangfùrkhô Loitho hâlâgî lâng.”
Beaunù Srî braiâ gaigainù lauthî
zang dru-dru bù-bù-bâ khîthû khîthû
dùì bùhùi bùnai, â-rù nâfrâ bù fai-
naise. Bîbaidînù dùisâ zânâise.
Obâsù unau nâfrâ Srî brai-nù lao
thaise â-rù khumrâ thaise hoṭaaise.
Phrâ bîkhônù lâbônânai sâse
kurmâ-nî nâ-i-au hâpfaibâ bînù zô
mîkhâm â-rù ômâ mâse buthâtnânai
hùnaise. Phâre okhâ naibâ Srî braiâ

happy in her husband’s society, and,
though he was very loth, prevailed
with him. And so in due course
there were born to them many sons
and daughters. And then, in order to
provide for their food, he journeyed
to the Himalayas and digged a great
tank, stocked with many kinds of
fishes.

Now, one day the god Sri, the god
of good luck, came that way with
his white dog, ahunting for deer and
hares and tortoises. And when he
came to the margin of the tank,
behold he was very thirsty. But
when he stooped to drink, the fishes
said to him eagerly that he must
grant them a boon in return for their
water. To which he assented, and
when he had satisfied his thirst, the
fishes said “Take us to the great
river, the Brahmaputra (or Lohit).”
So the god Sri tied them to his staff,
and drew them after him, making
runnels of water. And that is how
the rivers were made. And the fishes
in return gave him a pumpkin and a
gourd. And, taking these with him to
a friend’s house, his friend regaled
him with rice beer and pig’s flesh,
and in the morning he gave his

be khumrâ-khô bînî khurmânù
hunaise. Hùbâ bi khumrâkhô
dânkhaubâ thâkâ gazâ mannânai ârù
bâtî-se khâm zâhùnù lâgi omâ
buthâtnaise. Ârù omâ bikhau² man-
se dinnaise. Zâkhâng-ùi frâbùì fainù
nâmaibâ omâ bikhaukhô Srî brainù
hùnaise. Hùbâ ârù braiâ laukhòbù
khurmânù hùnaise. Bî lau-au darbî
gazâ dangman. Khintu be
khorângkhô braiâ mi-thiâ. Ârù bînî
khurmâiâ-bù bî-nù khithâ-i-â-
khùise. Unau braiâ nâi-au fainaise.
Ârù bîhâ nâ-i-au bînî fisâzù-khô
zâbrâ zânânai thânai nunaise. Bî lao
ârù khumrâ-khô bînî khurmâ-khô
hùlângnaikhai bîbaidî zâbrâ zânai
ârù bînî khurmâiâ-bù be lao ârù
khumrâ-khô lâkhmânaikhai zâbrâ
gabràp zânânai thânaise. Obâsù bînî
unau nâ-frâ ozâ zâ-thî-nânai bîsùr-nî
nâ-i-au thângnânai gadân nai-hùì-
nânai³ khithânaise “Nang-sùr zùsâ
mairong ârù goe zorâse fâthùì
zorâse ârù dau mâse lânânai dùisâ-i-
au hùnânai khulumbâ, nang-sùr-hâ
zâbrâ gâgan.” Besùr bibaidi-nù
khâmnânai zâbrâ gânaise. Bînîkhai
dâ Bâràfrâ dùisâ dùimâ fùrkhô
khulumù. Zapbai!

friend the pumpkin. But when his
friend cut open the pumpkin, it
contained nothing but pure silver.
So he bade the god Sri stay another
day, and brewed fresh beer and
killed another pig, and when he was
going away gave him a flitch of
bacon to take with him. So the god
Sri gave him also the gourd. But
when he cut open the gourd, it
contained nothing but pure gold.
And so the god Sri journeyed to his
home. And when he got there, he
found that his little daughter was
very ill. And that was because he
had given away the presents which
the fishes had made him. But the
fishes took pity on him, and came to
him in the guise of physicians, and
told him that if he would worship
and do sacrifice on the banks of
rivers, then his daughter would be
healed, which he did. And that is
why we Kacharis worship rivers.
And that is all.

Sâse olsiâ gâthâ nê khorâng.

Sâse olsiâ gâthâ dangman. Bî mâlai hâli oinânai mai gai zap-bâ, obâsù bî mâmâr dublîau hâli oi-hùi-dang. Phâre Bùthùr braiâ olsia gâthâkhô hâli oinai nunânai bî thângnù hâekhai, bungnaise. “Helùi gâthâ, nanglai dâ mâ hâli oidang-hùi, bùthùrâ mobâbânù thângbai. Dâ mai gaibâ, mâ zâbâu-nù?” Theobù bî bîkhô naifinâ, mosôkhô bù dhum dhum dhâm dhâm⁴ bunânai, nâtzret nâtflet bâli oibai thâiù. Unau braiâ khonle khonle sùngnaikhai gâthââ brâp-nânai nai-gedau-nânai bungnaise “Nanglai maunî brai lùì? Âng khô hâli oinaiau be baidî sùngbai thâiù? Anghâ mâ zâdang, âng sù mithîdang.” Beaunù braiâ bungnaise “Nonggâ, lùì âfâ, âng nangkhô gahâm khorâng-sù khithânù nâmaidang!” Beaunù gâthââ bungnaise “Mâ khorâng dang? Mâmâr khithâ! Âng hâli oinù sân zolângbai!” Obâsù braiâ bungnaise “Dâ hâli oinânai mâ zânù? Bùthùr thângbai,” hanbâ, gâthââ bungnaise “Bî bobething thângkhù? Mau thângkhù nang ângnù khithânanai hù. Âng mai gainù manâbâ, mâ zânânai thâng-gan?” Obâsù braiâ bungnaise “Nang âglânu mâlai zang lùgùse hâli oinânai mai gaibâ

The Story of the Lazy Boy.

There was once a very lazy boy. And when everybody else had planted out his paddy, he was only setting forth to plough. But the old man of the season,²⁷ seeing him, said “The season has gone; what are you ploughing for now? The paddy is all planted out, and it is late.” But the boy would not listen to him, and ploughed sturdily ahead, beating his cattle soundly as he went. And when the old man again and again questioned him, he cried “What sort of an old man is this? Can he not see that I am busy? I know very well what I am about.” But the old man said gently “Nay, my son: but it is for your good that I would speak to you.” And the boy said “Speak quickly then, and have done with it.” And the old man said “My son, the season is gone, what avails it to plough now?” And then the boy cried “Where has it gone? And when has it gone? And why has it gone? And how shall I find it?” But the old man of the season said “You should have ploughed when others did. The season has gone, and no man can bring it back.” But the boy said “I *must* bring it back, else, how shall I eat, and how shall I live? Do

hâmgauman, dâlai bùthùr-khô sùr
nunù hâgo, ârù mabrui bikhô laifin-
nù?” Beaunù gâthâa bungnaise
“Nang khithînânai hùnù hâbâ, âng
bikhô zeruibâbù lâbônù hâgan.”
Hanbâ, bikhô braiâ bülù hâekhai
khithânai “Nang bething thângui
thâbâ khârâ phut-thru-thru brai sâse
thokon thunânai dubli gezer gezer
thangnai nугan. Obâniâ nang
bikhônù hom. Ârù bî zere khithâ-i-ù
nang bebaidînù khâmdui” hannânai,
bùthùr braiâ thângnaise. Obâsù
gâthâa hâli hogârânânai nâiau
fainânai bîmâ buruikhô mâmâr
khâm songnù hùnânai, zâui lângui
bîmânù khithânai “Ai, nang gâbun
fungzânî khâm songnânai hù, ârù,
mairong khothâse bunnânai hù. Âng
bùthùr braikhô hùs-ù-lâng-nù.
nânggô. “Manâthù dinî âng hâli
oinaiau brai sâse fainânai mai
gainainî Bùthùrâ thangbai hannânai
khithânai, ârù bikhô hùsù lângbâ
mangan, ârù bîzere khâmnù thinù,
bebaidî-nù khâm hannânai
khithâlângnai.” Obâsù buruia okhâ
naibâ khâm songnânai gâthâkhô zâ-
hù-ùlâng-hù-ùl mairong khothâse
bunnânai hùnânai gâthâkhô
hogârnaise. Gâthâa thângui thângui
zaikhônù lùgù manù, bikh-ônù
sùngù, bîsùr bungù: “Bùthùr
thangbai hannânai mithigô. Bî
mabrui ârù bobething thâng-khù,
bikhô zangfùr khithânù hâiâ.”

tell me where it is gone.” And as he
would not let the god go, finally,
losing patience, he said “You go
over there, and you will find an old
man with a snow-white head
ploughing in a field. You get hold of
him and do as he tells you.” So
saying, he made his escape. Then
the lad hastened home to his mother
and bade her cook supper quickly,
and tie him up some rice to take
with him on the morrow, for he was
going to bring back the departed
season for ploughing.

“For” said he “when I was
ploughing today, an old man told me
that the season was gone, and that if
I went after him and pursued him I
would find him, and that I must do
as he would tell me.” So she rose
very early in the morning, and
giving him to eat and drink, set him
on his way. And as he went, he
asked all he met “Can you tell me
where the old man of the season has
gone?” But they said “Every one
knows that the season is gone, but
where it has gone, or why it has
gone, who can say?” At last, when
he was nearly in despair, he saw an
old man ploughing afar off, and
shouted to him “Stay a moment,
father, stay; I want to ask you a
question.” But the old man was
busy, and went his ways. But the lad

Beaunù gǎthǎa gadau-srau zânânai
bobething thāngan hannânai zerenù
manù erenù dubli gezer gezer thābai
baibā gazānau brai sāsē nuhoṭnaise
Nuhoṭbā bīnù bù-thùr zānù nānggō
nungnânai, bī-khō bungnaise “Āfā,
rǎthǎ! dāsē rǎthǎ! Ang nang-ni-au
manse khorāng sūngnù nāmaidang.”
Theobù braiā khnāsongālābā
thāngui thāiù. Gǎthǎa-bù khithù
khithù thāngui thāngui khithā-lāngù.
Gabauzang braiā nai fāfin-nanai
bungnaise “Mā hekhong-hekhong
sūr gǎthǎlùi maunī lùì nanglai?”
hannânai sūngbā gǎthǎa bungnaise
“Āfā brai, da brāp-lùi! ang manse
dukhuau gaglāi-nânai, nangnī
khāthiau faidang.” Hanbā, braiā
“Māmār khithā māmār khitha āng
thāngnù nānggō, ānghā nāa gazān,
hor-thō hui-gan;” hannaïse. Obāsù
gǎthǎa khithānaïse “Āfā āng
nangkhō bùthùr brai baidī nuiù.
Bīnīkhai nang āngkhō dā buthāt.
Mālaiā boibù mai gaithrā-bai āng un
zānanai daise bù gainù hā-e khui-se.
Bīnīkhai nang dāsē thāng-fāfin-bā
āngha mai zagan” bungnaikhai,
braia bīnù khithā-naïse “Āng dā
faibai, thāng fā-finnù hālia, nang
benīfrai māmār thāngnânai, zese
hāiù gathāng-gabrām hāli oinânai
mai gaihui-thāng.” Obāsù gǎthǎa
fainânai zerenù manù, erenù

pursued him and never ceased
calling after him till at last the old
man, losing patience, turned upon
him, and said “What pertinacious
noisy lad is this, who won’t leave
me alone?” But the lad said “Be not
angry, my father, I am fallen into
great trouble, and it behoves you to
help me.” “Speak quickly, then,”
said the old man. And the boy said
“I take you to be the old man of the
season, and I pray you not to slay
me. All the others have planted out
their paddy, and I have fallen
behind, and have planted nothing.
Therefore, unless you turn back, I
cannot hope to get any harvest.” But
the old man said “It is too late for
me to return. Go you back, and plant
your paddy as best you can.” And so
the lad hastened back and planted
out his seedlings in such heedless
haste as became him. And that’s all!

khothiâ⁵ khinî-khô gai-brop-nânai
dinnaise. Zapbai!

Găthă mămra nî khorâng.

Sânùi brai bừùihâ găthă sâse
dangman. Braiâ găthă uduibâ-nù
thoi-lâng-naise. Obâsù bîmâ bừùihâ
bîbai-nânai găthăkhô bângai fidit-bâ
găthăâ bungnaise “Ai, âng dâ mosô
gumnù hâ-sî-gô. Nả-se-au murkhiâ
hâpnù nâmaiù.” Bînî bîmâ
bungnaise “Âfâ fisâtlaiâ, nang âng
thoiâgo mâni dukhu zânù nânggâ.”
Khintu fisâtlaiâ bînî dukhu mon
hùâlâbâ sâse nî nâiau murkhiâ
hâpnaise. Phâre bîkhô murkhiâ-frâ
mosô gum-zâp-nù hùâ. Obâsù sâse
gurkhiâ braiâ bîkhô onnânai gum
zâp-hù-naise. Phâre gurkhiâfrâ
bîkhô nunù hâihâ, ârù boibù bu-i-ù.
Bînîkhai unau bî thâpnù hâekhai,
monau dukhu khâmnânai, bûidâkh-
sâri lângnaise.

Phâre thângùi thângùi bî nâmâ-i-au
Simlî Bîr khô lùgù mannaise. Phâre
bîkhô bungnaise “Dau, nanglai mâ
bîr lùì? Simlî bîfâng fângse mâni
bân-bù-dang!” Obânù bî bungnaise;

The seven Champions.

An old man and an old woman had
a son. But the father died while his
son was yet a child, and the mother
brought up her boy by begging from
house to house. When he was big
enough he begged his mother to let
him engage himself as a cowherd.
But she said “As long as I live, I
must not let you undergo any
trouble.” But the gallant boy would
not listen, and went and took service
as a cowherd. But the other cowherd
boys would not let him go out
herding with them, and hated him,
and beat him, in spite of the help of
a good old man who took him into
his house, so, being unable to stay
any longer for grief and vexation, he
went away into foreign lands.

And as he went his ways, he met
Simli Bîr, the hero of the *simul* tree,
and when he saw him he said “Ah!
here is a hero indeed, seeing that
you bear a whole silk-cotton tree on

ângnù mâ bîr, lùì, âdâ? Zekhô bungù
Gilâ Charan bîr, bîsù bîr!” Obâ
gâthââ bungnaise, “Bî bîrâ ângnù!”
Bungbâ, obâ, “Âng nang zang
thângfâgan lùì, âdâ.” Erui hannânai,
bî zang thângnaise. Beбайдinù
thânguì thânguì ârù Dhop Bîr khô
lùgù manbâ, bîkhô bù bungnaise
“Dau, be lai mâ bîr lùì? Dhop bîtâng
fângse mâni hâtsingnù bân-bù-gâr-
dang!” Obâsù bî bungnaise “Ang-lai
mâ bîr lùì, âdâfùr. Zi Gilâ Charan
bîr bî, sù!” Obâ Gilâ Charan
bungnaise, “E guì, bî lai ângnù
nanggâ lùì?” Erui hanbâ, “O âdâ,
obâ âng-bù nang sùr zang
thângfâgan,” hannânai bisùr zang
thângnaise. Beбайдinù Bîsor Bîr,
Bândor Bîr, Hâgor Bîr, ârù Oṭ Bîr
boi zang bîsùr sârâ bîr zânaise.
Beбайдinu lùgùse thânguì thânguì
sâse. Raikhô burui-nî nâ man-huì-
bâ, beaunù khâm song-zâ-nù lâgi
sâse bîr Raikhônî-au oṭ bainù
thângnaise. Thângbâ, Raikhô bûruiâ
mânsuì nunânai zânù lubuinânai
lomzâ-thî-nânai udunânai thânaise,
ârù bî bîrkhô bungnaise “Âbo, ângni
khâthi-au-nù oṭ dang, sukhângnânai
lângfai!” Hanbâ, bî fainânai
sukhângdangman. Ereaunù khathiau
thânai hâkhorau zùnânai
khùkhlainaise. Bîbaidi-nù gabâu
zâbâ, boibo sâse sâse thângnânai,
beaunù gaglai-thrâ-naise. Obâsù
Gilâ Charan bîrâ manse khorâng

your shoulder.” But the other replied
“Whom do you call a hero? I am no
hero at all. If you want a real hero,
look out for Gilâ Charan.” But the
lad said “As for Gilâ Charan, why, I
am Gilâ Charan.” On which Simli
Bîr got leave to go with him. And as
they went they met Dhop Bîr, and to
him they said “You are something
like a hero. Why, you are carrying a
whole *dhop* tree all by yourself.”
But the other said “My brothers, of
what account am I? The man they
call Gilâ Charan, he is a hero if you
like.” Then Gilâ Charan said “But I
am he.” On which Dhop Bîr said
“Let me come with you too.”

And, so saying, he too joined the
party. And in like manner they were
joined by other four champions,
namely, Mustard, Monkey, Ocean,
and Fire, six in all, besides Gilâ
Charan.

And when they had gone some way,
one of them went into the house of a
Râkshashani to beg fire for cooking.
But when the old wretch saw that it
was a man, she desired to devour
him, and to that end lay still,
pretending to be ill, and said to him
in a weak voice “The fire is quite
close to me. Come and blow it up!”
and when he came close, she gave
him a kick and sent him flying into

zâbai nungnânai bîau thângnânai,
Raikhô buruikhô nunaise. Obâsù bî
Raikhô burui khô sùbâ-khrâng hoṭ-
naise. Beaunù bùrùiâ dukhu
mannânai “Abo, nang ângkhô dâ
buthât!” hanbâ; “Obâ ângni âgùifùr
khô dĩhonnânai hù.” Ereui bungnai-
au-nù bùrùi zâkhlâ gongse lâbo-
nânai besurkhô hâkhor-nîfrai
dĩkhângnaise. Phâre unau bî Raikho
bùrùiikhô bùthât-naise.

Arù bîzang thânguì thânguì sâne
Raikhô thânai thauni man-hùi-naise.
Man-hùi-bâ, beaunù simlî-Bîr-khô
mikhâm song-nù thin-nânai, bîsùr
shikâr khâmnu thângnaise. Phâre bî
khâm songnânai dinnaise. Khintu
Raikho sânùî fainânai khâmkhô
zâfainaise. Phâre bîsùr fainânai,
“khâmâ hùrù?” hannânai bungbâ “E
âdâfur, âng mikhâm songnù
baugârbai lîfùr, manâthu âng gumâ
mazâng mâse nunânai bîkhô naibai
thâdangman.” Khintu Gilâ Charan
bî khorângkho mithîdangman.
Bînîkhai bî thânnânai khâm
songnaise. Phâre khâm zânù lâgi
Raikhô sânùî fainânai; “Ùi gâthâ!
zangfùrnù khâmâ hù lùì!” Hanbâ,
bungnaise “Zangfùrnù ukhùinânai

a pit; and, seeing that he did not
come, another champion went on
the same quest and was treated in
like fashion. Then Gilâ Charan
guessed that something out of the
way had happened, and went there
himself; and, perceiving that the old
woman was a vampire, took her by
the throat and shook her well. But
she cried “Do not kill me, and I will
show you where your friends are.”
Then the old woman got a ladder
and released the two champions
from the pit. Whereupon they killed
her, and went on their way rejoicing.

And presently they came to a place
where Rakshashas dwelt. But, not
knowing this, they left Simli Bîr to
cook rice and the rest went hunting.
And when the rice was ready, two
Rakshashas came and gobbled it up,
so when the rest returned, hungry,
for food, Simlî Bîr said he was very
sorry. He had quite forgotten to
cook, being very busy watching a
beautiful white butterfly. But Gilâ
Charan at once saw that was only a
pretext. So he bid the rest go, and,
staying behind, himself cooked rice
afresh. On which the two
Rakshashas came up roaring, and
said “Here, my son, hand over that
rice.” “But,” said Gilâ Charan,
undaunted, “we are hungry

dang, nangsurnù mabrùi hùgan!”
bungbâ “Gâdâ-i-au set-bâ gâkhir
onkhâtnai gâthâ-â-nù⁶ zangfurkhô
ereùi khithâiù nâ?” bungbâ,
sânùikhô-bù gâdâ homnânai Gilâ
Charanâ dubli dotse nî gazân
khubui-hot-naise. Obâsù bîsûr
bînîfrai bekhô zânù hannânai,
brâpnânai hârau-hurau hù-sù-lai-bù-
naise. Obâ bîsùr-khô-bù dân-thât-
naise. Beбайдînù sâ-thâm-nî-frai
sârâ-hâ-lâgi Raikhô bùthâtnânai,
Raikhôfurnî mikhâm songnai sârâ
hânthî hingzau lâbonânai, nâ
khâmnânai zâbai thânaise. Zapbai!

ourselves and have no rice to
spare!” “What!” cried they “shall a
scarcely weaned child speak to us
like this?” and they ran at him to eat
him. But he seized them by their
necks and threw them a field’s
length. And when they attacked him
afresh, he slew them with his sword.
And in like manner each of the Bîrs
slew each his Rakshasha, and then
each married a fair Rakshasha girl,
and lived happily ever afterwards.
And that’s all!

Sâse phâlangi gâthâni khorâng.⁷

Sâse uduiau-nù bîfâ thoizânai gâthâ
dangman. Phâre âzi âzi khâli khâli
bî gedet zâbâ sâse bîmânî-au
sùngnaise “Ai, âglâ zangfùrhâ âfâ-i-
â lai mâ maunânai zâdangman?”
hanbâ, bîmâiâ hâmbâ sunânai
khithânaise “Namfâiâ desù desù
fâlangî khâmnânai zâdangman. Bî
thâblâ, dâ zangfrâ esebù dukhu
zâiâman” hanbâ, bî bungnaise. “Uh!
obâ bî hâbâ-khô âng hâiâ nâ! Bese
thâkâ dang, ângnù dîhonnânai hù!”

The Story of the Merchant’s Son.

There was a lad whose father died
while he was a child. And when, by
slow degrees, he came to man’s
estate, he asked his mother one day
how his father got a living. But she
heaved a long sigh, and at last said
“Your father traded in foreign
countries, my dear; and if he were
alive now, we would not be in such
distress now.” But he said “Ah!
mother, may not I work at the same
trade? Give me all the money there
is, and let me too go trading.” But
his mother said “Nay! my son, do

Hanbâ, bîmâiâ bungnaise “Ăfâ nang
bîbaidî khâmnu nânggâ. Ăng bîui
gâpui nangnu zâhùgan. Nang
mâlainî dekhuau thângnânai
mâbruibâ thoibâ betbâ âng mâbrui
thâgan?” Theobù gâthâ â
khnâsongâlâbâ embrâ-brâ bîmâ-nî-
au thâkâ bînâ-nai lânânai bastu
bainaise, ârù nau gongse nâmainânai
lânaise, ârù gâsenù zâ zâbâ, mânsui
sânui-sù homnânai bîmâ buruikhô
khulumnânai mâlainî dekhu-au nau
zang thângnaise. Bebaidînu thângui
thângui gâmî dâtse dui-gâthan-au
naukhô khânânai, gâmî gâmi bastu
phân-hù-naise. Bî gâgai nau ne-ù.
Bebaidînu thâui thâui beau-nù sùrbâ
brai burui sâ-nui-hâ hângsù gufut
mâse dangman. Bînu bîsurnù dui
laiui mikham songui hùgrâ-man.
Bîkhônù sânsê bî gâthâ dui ga-
thânu gagainî hângsù-bîgur-khô
khûnanai din-nânai ârù mazâng
sikhlâ-sâ zânânai duguinai nunaise.
Bînfainù boi hângsù-nî girimâ
brai-bùrui-khô on-sù-nânai thau ârù
bînî nau-au zî zî bastu dang, ozâinu
bângai bângai hùnu homnaise.
Bîbaidînu bastufùrkhô fânui fânui
fân-zap-bâ nâiau fainai so-nai-khai
bî brai buruinî nâ-iau thângnânai
thâkâ zâbrâ hùnnânai, hângsù khô
bîbâ, brai bùruiâ “Erenù lâng”
hannânai bungdangman, khintu bî
fâfù-⁸nâng zânù gînânai, brai-nî-

not say that. While I live, even if I
have to beg, you shall not want. And
if you die in strange lands, what is
to become of me?” But her son
would not hearken to her, and,
begging money from her, bought
merchandise, and hired a boat, and
took two men with him; and, after
doing obeisance to his mother, set
forth into strange lands. And at last
he moored his boat at the *ghat* of a
certain village, and sent his men out
to hawk his goods. But he himself
stayed with the boat. And at that
ghat dwelt an aged couple, who
possessed a white and beautiful
swan which they cherished as their
own child, and fed with their own
food. And one day at midday, when
men were enjoying their *siesta*, the
merchant lad saw the white swan
remove her swan dress and bathe in
the river, a lovely slim maiden.
Whereupon he began to pay great
regard to the old couple, and gave
them of his store without money.
But as time went by, all his goods
were disposed of, and then he went
to the old people and offered them a
great price for their swan. Nor when
they would give it to him for
nothing would he accept it, seeing
that it were a sin to take a wife as a
gift. So, finally he made them take
much money and went away home,
taking his swan with him. But when

gnâng bastu-khai embrâ-brâ thâkâ
hùnânai hângsùkhô lâbônâise.
Bînîfrai nau lânânai fai-ùi faiùi nâ
man-fai-nânai, âzibù thâiù khâli-bù
thâiù bî hângsù mânsùi zâ-i-e
nunânai, sânfrimbù hâmlângnaise.
Bîkhônù nunânai bîmâ buruiâ
mâlainîau sùngbai baibâ raubù
mungbù khithânù hâiâ Khintu
biaunù bùrùi sâse dangman. Bînîau
sùngbâ, bî bungnaise “Âgùi, nang
bîkhônù mithiâkhùi nâ? Bî fâllângi
khâmnai thângnai-au bîhâ mâtâ
manse zâdang. Nang bîkhô buddi
khâmbâ, mithinù hâgan.” Hanbâ,
bîmâ bùruiâ bungnaise “Khithâ-hor-
hai, ai bùrùi, dhorom mangan.”
Hanbâ, bî khithânâise “Nang sânse
sâse sikhlâsa lâbônânai nangnî
gâthânî themâ nainù thin. Arù themâ
naibai thânai-au-nù gâpthînânai
sùng-thâng. “Nang mânù sânfrimbù
hâm-lâng-dang?” Obânù bî bîkhô
on-khâng-nânai bînî monau zî
khorâng dang, bî khithâgan.”
Hanbâ, bîmâ bîbaidînù khâmnâise.
Hingzausâ-iâ themâ nainaiu-nù
gâpthînânai gongrai surukhù
surukhù⁹ sùngnaise “Adâ-lùi, nang-
hâ-lai mâ zâdang? Nang bekhô khi-
thâiâbâ, âng bù khâm dùì zâiâ,”
hannaikhai gâthââ hâmbâ sunânai,
bînù lâse lâse khithânâise “Ang
fâllângi khâmnù thângnai-i-au dâ
ângnî nâ-iau zî hângsù gufut mâse

he reached home, behold the swan
remained a swan, and the lad was
sore vexed and lost his sleep and his
food, so that his mother was in fear,
and asked sundry of the villagers
what might be the matter.

And, finally, one of them, who was
a wise woman, said to her:
“Something has happened to him
while he was away trading, and now
you must find out what it was. And
the way to do it is this: You must get
a fair girl to comb his hair; and let
her pretend to grieve that he is so ill,
and let her cry into his hair, and to a
fair maiden he will tell what he
would never say to his mother.” So
a girl came and combed his hair, and
wept silently till the tears fell on his
head, and when he asked what ailed
her, said she could not bear to see
him pine away. So at last he told her
of the white swan, which turned
before his very eyes into a lovely
maiden, but that now it remained
ever a white swan, though he was
pining away for very love of her. So
she went and told the mother, and
the mother told the wise woman,
who bade them get the lad to lie
awake till midnight and then the
swan-maiden would arise, and,
assuming her maiden form, would
worship her own country’s gods.
And then he was to leap up

dang, bîkhô mânsùi zânai
nudangman. Khintu bî dâ baidî-sùi-
ùi-nù thâbai. Bînîkhai âng erebaidî
zâdang.” Themâ nai-khângbâ be
gâsenù khorâng hingzausâiâ bînî
bîmâ-nù khithânâise. Bekhô bîmâiâ
khnânânai boi bûrûinù khithâ hùi-
naise lâiù. Buruiâ bîkhô khnânânai
buddî hùnaise lâiu: “Nang dinî boi
hingzausâkhô lâbonânai khithânânai
hù, bî dinî hoṛau udu-lâng-thî-nânai
thâthang. Hoṛ gezerbâ hângsùâ
mânsùi zânânai gagainî
modaifûrkhô khulumbai thâiù.
Beaunù bî hângsù bîgurkhô zuzai-
mù-au sùnânai hùbâ, obâniâ mânsùi-
i-nù thâ-sî-gan.” Be buddi hùnai-
baidînù bîmâiâ hingzausâ-nù
khithânâise, ârù hingzausâiâ bù
gâthânù khithânânai hùnaikhai,
sânse gâthââ khurui gongseau
khârezang thauzang golainânai
dinnai, ârù songor manse dinnaise.
Hoṛ zâbâ bî udui-thî-lâng-nânai
thâbâ, hângsùâ hoṛau sikhângnânai
âkhaiau âthengau modom au-bù
khepthu-bai-dang.¹⁰ Theobù bî khet-
khut khâmâ-khuise. Bînîkhai bî udu-
lângmâtbai nungnânai, gagainî
hângsù bîgùr khô lâsehai khunânai
dinnânai gâgainî modai-fûr-khô
mon hùnânai khulumbâi
thâdangman. Ere-au-nù srî-srî
lâsehai sikhângnânai boi hângsù
bîgùrkhô thâpnehai zuzai-mù-au

suddenly and cast her swan skin on
the hearth and burn it; and then of a
surety she would remain a maiden.
So the lad prepared a basin of oil
and ashes and a yak’s tail, and did as
the wise woman bade. And in the
depth of night, the swan came and
felt him all over with her beak. But
he never stirred a whit. And then,
believing him to be asleep, she
stripped off her swan’s skin slowly,
and prayed aloud to the gods of her
own country. Then the lad got out of
bed very silently, and seizing the
swan’s skin thrust it in the ashes.
And when she smelled the burning
feathers, she cried aloud “Ah! what
have you done? what have you
done?” and fell senseless on the
floor. But he anointed her with the
oil, and fanned her with the yak’s
tail, till presently her great eyes
opened and he saw that she loved
him. And then they lived happily
ever afterwards. And that’s all!

efopnânai dinnaise. Unau bigurâ
khâmânai manâm-khang-bâ, bîkhô
manâmânai mannânai “Ângkhô mâ
khâmkhù, mâ khâmkhù?” hannânai,
fâtdrâp-dô gaglainânai khânggrâng-
nânai thoi-hâp-nânai thânaise.
Obâsù gâthââ mâmâr fainânai
khuruinî thaukhô khâra-modom-
âtheng-âkhai-au hùnânai, songor
zang sîpbai thânaise, ârù bîbaidînu
sîpùi sîpùi thâblâ, gabâu-zang hâma
sukhângnaise, ârù thâng-khâng-
naise. Bîbaidî-nù mânsùi zânânai,
sânùi-zang hâbâ khâm-lai-nânai
zâbrâ dinhâ lâgi fisâ fisù zang rozo-
rù-man zâlai-bai thânai-se. Zapbai!

Bîdâ bînânaunî khorâng.

Sâse razâ ârù rânî dangman. Bîsùr
hâ hoâiâ thoi-grù-naise. Bî thoibâ
hingzauâ modomau dangman.
Sânne-sù thânanai hingzausâ sâse
zânaise. Ârù bîsùrhâ hoâsâ bù sâse
dangman. Phâre sân-ne-sù thânnânai,
bîsùrnî bîmâiâ thoinaise. Thoibâ
hingzausâ nî bidâiâ bîkhô gâkhîr
daunânai fidet-naise. Phâ unau bîsùr
zânù-gùie zâlângnânai unau gâmi
gâmi bîbainânai zânânaise.
Bîbaidînu thâbai-ùi thabai-ùi sâse
râzâ nî nâ-î-au hâp-hùi-naise.

Brother and Sister.

A certain king died, and soon after
his death his wife bare him a
daughter, as she had heretofore
borne him a son. And then she too
died. But before she died, she bade
her son “Strike hard, but once
only!” And she committed her
daughter to his care. And, though
they lost their kingdom and were
forced to beg their bread, the brother
was a good brother, and took care of
his sister until they came to a certain
kingdom, the king of which took

Beaunù Razâiâ onnânai bîsùrkhô
bînî nả-î-au dinnai.

Be dekhu-au sikhau sâ-snî dangman.
Bîsùrnù rằzâiâ ozainù dau, omâ,
mosô, phâreo hùnânggô. Be
khorângkhô gằthằ-mằmrằiằ
khnânânai, bîsùr-khô dânthậtnu lằgi
razằ-nằ-au sùngnaise. Khintu razằhằ
bikhô thinnù mon gủiằman. Theobù
bînî mon zang-nù thin-naise. Obằ
gorai mằse emfui gongse razằnằau
bînânai lằnằnai, be sikhaurằnằ
nằiằu thằngnằnai gorai khỏ dằpseu
khằnằnai dinnằnai, bằ emfui lằnằnai
dor-mukhằngằu srằ srằ zombai thằ-
naise. Unau be sikhau gedetsinằ
onkhằrbằbằ bằkhỏ dân-naise. Ầrằ
boikhỏbằ sằse sằse bepaidi-nù
dằnnaise. Khintù boinủkhrằ uduisủiằ
monau bằngai gằnằnai, lằse lằse
fainaiằu bằkhỏ gằhằmủi dằnnù
manằkhuise. Beaunù thoi-e-khai bằ
bằsủrằnằ nằ gongseu bằkhỏ sùnằnai
tằlằ mằrằnằnai dinnaise. Manằthu
ằglằ bînằ bằmằiằ bằkhỏ zằ dânằ-bằ
phongse bằ dânằ
thinlằngdangman. Bằnằkhai bằ bằkhỏ
ằrằ dằnnù hằiằ-khuise. Unau be
khorângkhỏ razằnằ sigằng-au gằsenù
khithằ-naise. Beaunù razằiằ
sikhaurằnằ nằkhỏ bằsủr sằnekhỏ
girimằ khằmnaise. Beaunù bằsủr
thằnằnai bằdằiằ binằnằu-khỏ
khithằnaise “Ầgủi, nang be gằsenủ
nằ gongse gongse-ủi nằnằ lubuibằ,

pity on them and kept them in his
own palace.

Now, in that kingdom dwelt seven
thieves, who oppressed the king, so
that he was compelled to send them
fowls, pigs, cattle, and pigeons
every day. And when the brother
heard of this, he begged the king to
let him go and kill the thieves. And
when the king was unwilling to let
him undertake the enterprise, the
brother insisted, and, borrowing a
horse and a sword from the king,
went to the thieves' house, and there
tied up his horse and waited with
drawn sword at the door. And when
the eldest thief came out, he cut him
down, and so in turn he cut down
each of them. But the youngest of
all was suspicious and came out
cautiously, so that the brother was
not able to kill him at one blow. So,
mindful of his mother's saying, he
shut him up in one of the thieves'
houses, and put a lock upon the
door. And then he went and told all
that had happened to the king; who,
as a reward made the brother and
sister custodians of the thieves'
houses. And so they went and stayed
there, and the brother said to his
sister “You can go into and examine
all the houses except the one that is
locked.” And the brother was a
mighty hunter. But before he went

nainù hâgo. Khintu be tâlâ-mârinai-
khô nang dâ kheo.” Bîdâiâ shikâr
khâmgrâ-man. Phâre shikâr khâmnu
thângbâ, bînânaunu sobai zang
mairang zang golainânai, khurui
gongseau hùlângnaiman. Bî bîkhônù
sânse mâni bâsîbai thâdangman.
Unau sân-ne-sù thânânai, bi gâsenù
nâ-fùr-khô kheo-e kheo-e nainaise.
Khaise-au mosô, khaise-au gorai,
khaise-au dau, bebaidînù nâfrimbù
bî nainaise, Khintu bî kheonu hù-i-e
nâkhô mon khâmnnânai naiâlâbâ
thânù hâiâkhùise.

“Mânâthù beaubù mâ dang âng
nunù nânggô;” erùi hannânai bî
kheonânai naibâ, thoi-hâng thoi-
hâng mânsùi sâse nunaise. Beaunù
bî khulumbâ, onnânai, bî zî
khithâiù, bîkhônù lânânai, muli
hùnaise. Beaunù sân ne sù thânânai
mânsùiâ gahâm zânaise. Phâ
bîbaidînù ozainù railainù ârù bînù
khâm dùi hùnù homnaise. Bebaidinù
thaie thaie bîsùr khoràng zâlainaise.
Phâ unau bîdâkhô buthâtnù lâgi
sikhauâ, hingzaukhô buddi hùnaise
“Nang dînî zobrà zâ-thî-nânai thâ,
ârù khithâ: ângnù mosâ-gâkhir
zâhùbâ, âng gahâm zâgan.” Bibaidi-
nù bidânù khithânaise. Bidaiâ
khnânânai hâgrâ-bâre-au mosâ
nâmai-lâng-naise. Bînî khâfâlùi¹¹
mosâ bîmâ mâse hâthâi-au mosô
begeng nâng-phthânânai thânai lùgù

out a hunting, he mixed pulse and
grain, and, filling a plate with the
mixture, bade his sister separate the
seeds while he was away. And this
occupied her a whole day. And then
she went and examined all the
rooms in the thieves' houses. And in
some were cattle, and in some
fowls, and in some horses, and so
forth. But her mind was ill at ease,
because she might not examine the
house that was locked. “For,” she
said to herself, “if I do not see what
is in that house, I cannot be happy.”
So she went and saw, and there she
found a man half dead with his
wound; and when he besought her,
she pitied him, and fetched him such
medicines as he required of her. So
that at the end of some days he was
healed, and in course of time they
two fell in love with one another.
And the wicked thief began to teach
the girl how she should bring about
the destruction of her brother. And
he bade her, when her brother
returned, to pretend to be ill, and to
say that nothing would cure her save
a drink of tigress' milk. And when
her brother heard this, he set out in
search of a she-tiger. And, as luck
would have it, he found a she-tiger
with a bone stuck in her teeth. So,
after binding her with a vow, he
extracted the bone from her teeth,
and then he told her what he

man-naise. Beaunù mosâkhô sùmai lâhùnânai hâthai-nîfrai begeng-khô dîhonnaise. Unau bî mosânî gâkhir-nî khorâng khithânaikhai bî gaigai nî gâkhir ârù fisâ bù mase hùnaise. Bekhô lâbonânai binânaunù hùfainaise. Phâre okhâ naibâ, sikhauâ, bî hingzaukhô sùngnaise. “Nangnù mosâ gâkhir hùfai-nù nâ?” Bî khithânai, gâkhir ârù bînî fisâ bù mase âdâiâ lâbodang.” Biau bî hamâ man-naise. Ârù sânsê fukuri manse-nî dùì lâbonù khithânai. Bî fukuri-nî dùìkhô lâbobâ mânsuîâ thoiù. Beaunù binânauâ bidânù khithânai, “Nang be fukuri-nî dùì ângnù lâbonânai hùbâ, âng gahâm zâgan Bebaidînù bidaiâ gorai mase emfui gongse sùimâ mase ârù mosâ-fisâ-khô bù lânânai thângnaise. Thânguì thânguì bongfâng gedet fângse man-hùinânai, be bongfâng singau-nù bî zirainânai dang. Ereaunù zibaù gedet mase bî bongfangau mânânai gâkhùlâng-dâng, nunânai, bîkhô emfui zang dân-so-naise. Ârù dâse thânânai, ârù mase zibaù bîbaidînù gâkhùlângnai-au bîkhô-bù dânnaise. Bîbaidînù bî beaunù dang, obânù dau gedet mase be bongfangau bîrbùnânai fisâ-furnù âdhâr hùbâ, fisâfrâ zâiâkhùise. Obâ bîmâ bungnaise; “nangfùr dinî mânù âdhâr zâiâ?” Obâ fisâfrâ khithânai “Bongfang singau thânai mânsuîkhô nang on-bâ,

required. So she gave him of her milk, and also one of her whelps. And then he returned home. And at dawn the thief asked the sister “Did he bring you the tigress’s milk?” And she replied “That he did, and he brought a tiger’s whelp also.” On which the thief was much discomfited. Then he bade her ask her brother fetch some water from a certain tank, well knowing that to fetch water from that tank, was certain death. On which she said to her brother “If you can only get me water from that tank, I shall certainly be well.” So the brother took his horse and a sword, and a hound, and also the tiger’s whelp, and set out. And on the way he came to a great tree and stopped to rest in the shade; and while he was resting, a huge snake came and began climbing up the tree. And, seeing it, the brother cut the snake in two with his sword; and when a second snake came, he slew that, too. And while he was still resting, a bird came flying to the tree with food for her nestlings. But they refused to eat. And when their mother asked them why they would not eat, they said “Unless you take pity on the man who is resting under the tree, we cannot eat.” So the mother bird promised; and, having fed her nestlings, flew down to the brother

zangfùr âdhâr zâgan.” Hanbâ,
 bimâiâ “ongan” hannânai sumai
 lânaise. Fisâfrâ âdhâr zâkhânguì-frâ-
 bùi, bimâiâ mânsùi-khô sùng-naise
 “Nangkhô mâ nânggô?” Sùngbâ, bî
 khithânâise “Ângnù bî fukuri-ni dùì
 nânggô.” Be dauâ fukuri-nî khorâng
 boikhô-bù mithînânai bînù
 khithânânai hùnânai bîkhô be fukuri
 khâthiau dinhùinaise. Be fukuri
 khathiau-nù fukuri-nî girimâ
 khunguri¹² sâse dangman. Gâthâ
 mâmrâiâ bînî nâ-i-au hâpnânai
 khungari zang gâsenù khorâng-
 bâthrâ zâlai-nâise. Obâ khunguriâ
 “Nang-nî khorâng-khô âng
 boikhôbù mithî-bai. Nang ângkhô
 hâbâ khâm. Be fukuri-nî dùìkhô
 nang lâng-nù hâiâ: thoigan. Ârù
 nang-khô buthât-nù lâgi-sù nangnî
 nang-nânauâ, upai khâmdang. Nang
 zî mânsùi dân thârâ-lâbâ dindang-
 man; bî sikhâua-nù be gâsenù
 khôrang khâmdang.” Erùì han-nânai
 bisùr sânebù failainaise, ârù bînî
 bînânau ârù sikhaukhô dân-thât-
 nâise. Dânthât-nânai, bîsùr sânezang
 beaunù girimâ zânânai thânaise.
 Zapbai!

and asked him what he desired. And
 he said that he desired water from a
 certain tank. But the bird knew all
 about the properties of the tank, and
 told the brother. Now, near the tank
 dwelt a maiden, the guardian of the
 tank; and he entered into her house,
 and told her his heart’s desire. But
 she said to him “You must not go
 near the tank, for you will die. You
 must marry me. And as for your
 sister, she has disobeyed your word,
 and has married the thief you nearly
 killed, and their desire is only to be
 rid of you.” So they two were
 married, and, going to the thief’s
 house, slew the thief and the wicked
 sister. And then they lived happily
 ever afterwards. And that’s all!

Brai bừrùi sầnùì dangman. Bìsùrhâ
zânù lùngnù gùìâman. Bînîhai sen-
khokhâ sananai, zî nâ manù,
bîzangnu mai slailânai mikhâm zâiù.
Bebaidînù khâmùì khâmùì sânse
senau nâ mâsebù nângâlâbâ, embu
bonglâ gazâ senau thîp nângânai
thâđang. Obâsù braiâ dâulâ gesîpâ
sâünù thângnânai, sen nai-hùinaise,
ârù sen khô dikhângnânai ilit
mannaikhai rong zânânai, mâmâr
bîbân khânânai, nả-hâ-lâgi băt-zret-
băt-thet bân-bù-naise. Ârù bừrùi-
khô phuzâ-nânai bungnaise “Bừrùi,
bừrùi, mâ dâbù uthiâ-lùi? Sân-
zâbai!” Hannânai, phùzâbâ bừrùiâ
mâmâr sikhângnânai oť sunânai
sâne-zang oť sailainaise. Ârù braiâ
bungnaise “Zangfùrhâ dinî khaphâl
gâham! Senau nâ thîp-bungnânai
thâđang!” Obâsù bừrùiâ bungnaise
“Hùrù, hùrù! nai-nî, lâbonai!”
hanbâ, braiâ mâmâr khithîfainaise.
Ârù brai bừrùiâ sầnùizang orau
gahâmùì nainânai nunaise gâsenù
embubonglâ gazâ. Obâsù bừrùiâ
braikhô bungnaise “Dinî nanghâ
khaphâlâ gahâm zâđang! Ga-
hâmùìnù khâm manzâsîgan!”
hannânai bungbâ braiâ senkhô
dảkhânaise, ârù buruikhô buthâtnù
thin-bâ, bừrùiâ gon gongse lânânai
thả thả bù-thât-hù-lâng-naise.
Emphâre bùthât-zap-bâ mâse âtheng
bainânai thoifrâmnânai bừrùi-nî
khâmflai singau thâđangman. Unau

There was an aged couple, who
were very poor. But they had a fish
trap, which they set at night; and the
fish they caught they exchanged for
rice. And one night it happened that
no fish got into the trap, but only
toads, so that the trap was brimfull.
And at early dawn, when the cock
crowed, the old man came, and
finding the trap very heavy was
rejoiced, and hoisting it on to his
back waddled away. And when he
got home he woke up his wife,
crying “Old woman, old woman, not
up yet? The day has dawned.” So
the old woman jumped up, and blew
up the fire, and the old couple
squatted over it, warming
themselves. And the old man said
“We are in luck to-day! The trap is
brimfull.” Then the old woman said
“Let’s see, let’s see.” So the old man
tumbled out the contents of the trap,
and, behold, they were all toads. So
the old woman said “We *are* in luck
to-day! We shall have lots to eat to-
day!” And the old man bid her kill
the toads without further words.
And the old woman, taking her
stick, ran about after the toads and
slew them one by one. But one
alone, half dead with fear, crawled
under the old woman’s stool. But
the rest she skinned and cleaned.
Then, removing the stool, the old
man saw the survivor, and said to

gâsenù embu-fùr-khô sâi-khâng-nânai, brai bûrûiâ bînîfrai uthîbâ ârù khâmflai dikhângbâ, be thoifrâmnai embukhô nunânai, braiâ, “Bûrûi, mâse embu thâbai, bûthât! bûthât!” Hanbâ, embuâ rai-dau-naise “Âfâ lùì âng-khô dâ bûthât: âng nangnù hâli oinânai, khodâl zaunânai, mai gainânai hùgan.” Obâsù braiâ bung-naise: “Mobâthù embu-bonglaia hâbâ maunânai hùnai nudang-lùì? Nang hâbâ maunânai hùnaia gakhâ! Buthâtzânù gînânai nang bekhônù khithâdang.” Bungbâ, embu bonglâiâ gahâmùì khulum-bai-nai-khai, ârù sumai lâ-nai-khai, braiâ bûrûiâ onnânai bîkhô buthârâlâbâ nâ-i-au dinnaise. Obâsù âjibù thâiù kâlîbùthâiù dùilâng bûthùr sâbâ, embu-bonglâiâ nângal lânânai dubliâu hâli oinù thângnaise. Ârù bî nângal-mothiaù gâ-khù-nânai hâli oibai thâbâ, bînî dubli thing sùrba rajâ sâse hâthi gânânai fainai nubâ embubonglâ raihoṭnaise “Helùì, helùì, nang maunî mânsùì lùì? Âng nî âli-fùr-khô gâphle-gâsi khâm dang!” Hanbâ râzâiâ, “Âng khô bebaidî rainaiâ sùr?” Hannânai, mânsùì hoṭbâ, sâfrâ singau hâkhmânânai thâiù. Bînîkhai mânsùìâ nunù hâekhai thâng-phâphinse. Bebaidînù khonle khonle raiù, khon-frimbù bîkhô nunù hâekhai râzaiâ mosôkhônù lânù thinnânai nâ-hâ-lâgi lângnaise.

the old woman “There is one left; kill that, too!” But the toad called out “Ah! father, do not kill me. I will plough for you, and hoe for you, and plant out paddy for you!” But the old man replied “How shall a toad do all these things? *Your* ploughing and hoeing would be a bitter business! You only want to get off being killed.” But he pleaded so sore, and begged so hard, that they took pity on him and let him stay in their house. And so the days went by till the rainy season came round, and the toad went off to plough in the field. And as he was sitting on the handle of the plough urging on his cattle, a king came by that way riding on his elephant, and the toad called out to him “What fellow is that? You are knocking down all the balks of my field!” To which the king replied “Who dares speak to me thus,” and sent men to fetch him. But he hid behind a clod, so that they could not find him. And when he continued to abuse them without their finding him, the king bade them take away the plough cattle to his house. And the toad, followed secretly behind, and, hiding himself in the thatch of the cowshed, began to abuse the king afresh. And the king searched for him in vain; and at last ordered the cowshed to be pulled down and the cattle to be put

Obàsù bì bù khîthu khîthu
thângnânai gogrâ nî nâ sâiau thurui
singau hâpsù-nânai thânânai rajâ
khô baidî baidî raibai thâ-sùnaise.
Râjâiâ bîkhô khnânânai, naibâbù
nuekhai brâpnânai gogrâkhônù
sefainù thinnaise. Khintu bì bînîfrai
thângkhmânânai saurâ nâ sâ-i-au
thânânâi ârù rainaise Beбайдînù
gâsenù nâ sephainù gnâng
zânaikhai, râzâiâ unau gînânai bîkhô
gahâmùì sùngnaise, “Helùì âfâ,
nanglai modai nâ mânsùì? Âng
nangkhô mungbù khâmliâ.” Hanbâ,
bì bungnaise “Âng modai nunggâ,
mânsùì-sù. Ârù nang ângnî mosâ
lâbonai-khai âng nângkhô raidang.
Ârù nang dâ nangnî phisazùkhô âng
zang hâbâ khâmnânai hùgan
hannânai sumai lâiâ gô mâni, âng
nangkhô beбайдînù nue zânânai
raibai thâgan.” Hanbâ, râzâiâ sumai
lânângnaise. Obânia bì nânîfrai
onkhâtnaise. Onkhâtâ râzâiâ sumai
lânaikhai, ârù mâbâ modai-fùr zânù
hâgô nungnânai, hâbâ khâmnânai
hùnaise, ârù dolâ, hâthi, gorai gâ-
khù-hù-lainânai nâhâlâgi hoṭbâ ârù
brai bùrùinî nâ khâthî man-fai-ba,
brai bùrùia gînânai, nâ-nîfrai
khâtlângdang-man. Bîkhô embu-
bongla fisâtlâiâ nunânai “Gînù
nânggâ” hannânai, mânsùì hoṭnânai
lâbo-finnaise. Obàsù brai bùrùì
fisâtlâ ârù bîhâmzù boibù zâ zânânai
rong zâ-lainânai mânsùì fùrkhô

elsewhere. And the toad went and
hid there, too, and abused the king
again. Finally, the king was
frightened and called to him: “Oh!
father, are you god or mortal? And
what harm have I done you?” And
he said “I am mortal of a sooth. And
I abuse you because you have
carried off my cattle. And if you do
not give me your daughter in
marriage, I shall remain invisible
and abuse you daily.” So the king
swore that the toad should have his
daughter, and the toad came forth.
And the king, for his oath’s sake,
and lest the toad should be in some
sort a god, gave him his daughter,
and sent him home with a sedan-
chair and elephants and horses. And
when he got near his home, the old
man and old woman ran clean away.
But the toad, their adopted son,
seeing their terror, bade them not be
afraid, and sent men after them to
fetch them. And then they sat down
with their son-in-law and daughter-
in-law and feasted the men who had
come with them. And one day the
girl, finding her husband very
loathsome to look upon, told him to
take a bath. “But,” said her husband,
“what is the good of my taking a
bath? I am a frog and always
bathing.” But his wife replied “I
know very well that you live in cold
water. But I want to get rid of those

khâm-dùi zâhùnai lùnghùnaise.
Bebaidînù thâui dang, sânsê
bîhâmzùâ embu-bonglâ-khô nainù
bânânai embu-bonglâ-khô duguinù
thinnaise. Embu bonglaiâ bungnaise
“Âng udui-nî-frai dùi-au-nù thâui.
Dâ dughuibâ ânghâ mâ zânù?” Obâsù
hingzauâ bungnaise “Nang dui
gusu-au thânai-khô âng mithîdang.
Khintu nangnî bîkhong-nî gâdi-mâlâ
nunânai-sù âng nangkhô thukuinù
nâmaidang,” hanba, embu bonglâiâ
mânthi zânaise. Zâbâ dùi gloplop
phûdung-nânai hoâkhô linghotnaise.
“Mâmâr faidù! Âng thukuinù
nânggo.” Bî mâmâr fainânai,
sùngbâ; “Nang âglâ duiâu bêt-sùm
grù. Âng unau bîkhong hùnânai
hùgan,” hanbâ, bî bîâu bêt-sùm-
nânai khâng-grâng-nânai thoinânai
thânaise. Zapbai!

nasty protuberances on your back,
and want to bathe you.” So, finally,
her husband agreed. So she heated
some water to boiling, and called
out “Come quick, I must bathe
you!” And when the toad came, and
asked what he was to do, she said
“You jump straight in, and I will
bathe you afterwards.” So he
jumped in, and, turning over on his
back, died. And that’s all!

Mùi ârù daukhâ dandâ nî khorâng.

Bîsùr sâne zang âglânîfrai fisikî
man. Ârù bîsùr bongfâng fângseau
ozainù lùgùse thânaïman. Phâre
sânse mùikhô sel mâsêâ nunânai
bîkhô gufûng ârù zânù lâgi gahâm
nunânai selâ raidaunaise “Helùi

The Story of the Doe and the Raven.

The doe and the raven were great
friends, and lived together in the
shade of the same tree. And one day
a jackal, seeing the doe, and finding
her to be fat and good to eat, said to
her “Oh friend, what are you doing

khurmâ! Nang beau mâ nâmaidang?
Âng nang khô nunânai on-sùdang
ârù nanghâ khusi dangbâ, âng nang-
zang khurmâ khâmgan.” Beaunù
mùiâ bungnaise: “Nangzang
ângzang mâbrùi khurmâ zânù hângô?
Nang ângni hothru. Nang ângkhô
manbâ, nang ângkhô zângô. Âng
nangnî bîdot.” Be khorang
khnânânai selâ monau dukhu
mannânai bungnaise “Nang zî
khorâng khithâdang, gâsenù
nunggô. Ârù bînîkhâi ângghâ raubô
guiliâ, thoithro-bai. Bînîkhâi âng dâ
monau gunîânai gokhainî¹⁴ haran
lâbai. Ârù nang boidî raunîbù
mungbù khâme, omâzang khurmâ
khâmnù mon zâdang. Nang ângkhô
beau mungbù dâ bung.” Be
khorâng-au-nù mùìâ mânthî zânâise.
Obâ bîsùr sâne zang bongfâng
guriau thâng-lai-naise. Beaunù
daukhâ-dandâ-î-â sel-khô nunânai,
bîkhô âgâr-nù lâgi mùinù zâbrânù
gahâm khorâng khithâdangman.
Khintu be khorâng-khô mùìâ khnâ-
song-hiâ-khai, daukhâ dandâiâ
sâkhthar manse khithânâise: “Sâne
fisikhî dangman-nù. Bîsùr sâne zang
khorâng khâlâinaise zî “Zangfùr
zebù dukhuau gârlainù nânggâ.”
Phâre sânsê bîsùr maubâ thângnaiau
hâgrâ gezer gezer thângdangman.
Beaunù lâmbâ gezerau mâfur mâse
lùgù man-naise. Phâ bîsùr sânnù nî

there? I am charmed to see you, and,
if you permit, would like to swear
eternal friendship.” But the doe said
“How can there be friendship
between the likes of us? we are
sworn foes. If you get hold of me,
you will eat me. I am your food.”
But the jackal, on hearing this,
pretended to be mightily grieved,
and said “What you observe is true
enough, and that is just why all my
family are dead and I alone am left.
And, considering these things, I, for
my part, am turned Hindu, eat no
flesh, and have vowed friendship to
all animals. So you need be in no
fear of me.” To which the doe
attached implicit credence, and so
they two walked together under the
trees. But the raven came up and
said all he could to induce the doe to
abandon the fellowship of the
jackal. But, as he could not prevail
with her, he told her the following
story: “Once upon a time there were
two friends. And they vowed that if
ever they fell into danger, they
should on no account leave one
another. And one day they were
going through the jungle together,
when they met a bear. Now, one of
them could climb trees, and the
other could not. And when the bear
pursued them, the one scrambled up
into the first tree he met. But the
other, not knowing what else to do,

gezerau sâse bongfâng gâkhùnù
hâgoman, sâse haiâman. Zeblâ
mâfurâ hù-sù-bù-dang, sâse
khâtnânai bongfângau
gâkhùhùinaise. Sâseâ mungbô upai
mane zânânai hâiau khuglupnânai,
hâng lâiabâ thânaise. Unau mâfurâ
fainânai bikhô manâm-su-nânai
hâng gùie nunânai, gârlângnaise.
Phâ bongfângnî mânsùîâ sùngnaise
“Helùi sikhî, nangkhô mâfurâ
manâm-su-nânai mâ khithânai?”
Beaunù bî bungnaise “Bebaidî
mânsùî-zang nang khurmâ dâ
khâm,” erùi hannânai bungnai.”
Daukhâ dandâ bungnaise “Besùr
sânùi-nî baidi nang-hâ-bù zânù
hâgô. Theobù mùîâ bînî khorâng
khô lâiâkhùise. Phâre âzi-bù-dang
kâli-bù-dang sâse selâ phân
nunânai mùikhô bî thauni-hâ lâgi
bîkhô phânu khùkhlainaise. Phâre
bî phân-nî deoling-khô oṭ-sonù
thinbâ-bù, otnù manâ hannânai
oṭsoâkhùise. Unau daukhâîâ bîsùrnî
khorângkhô mithînânai nâmai-lâng-
nânai mùikhô phânu nângnânai
thânai nunaise. Nubâ, bîkhô gahâm
khâmnù lâge upai khâmnaise. Phâre,
okhâ naise naise zâdangman,
ereaunù bî bungnaise “Sikhî nung
uduikhô dukhrâng hùnânai hâng
laiâlâbâ thâ. Ârù âng gâp-bâ, nang
khât. Be upai-au goâbâ, ârù gùîîâ-
se.” Bî khithânai-baidi-nù mùîâ
khâmnânai dang. Ereau-nù phân-nî

lay on the ground, and, pretending
to be dead, held his breath. And the
bear, coming and sniffing at him,
and finding him apparently dead,
left him. Then his friend, shouting
to him from the tree, said “What
was it that the bear whispered to
you?” And he replied “The bear said
to me ‘never make friends with men
like that fellow in the tree.’” “And
so,” said the raven, “will it be with
you and your friend the jackal.” For
all that, the doe refused to listen,
and after some days the jackal,
when walking out with the doe,
spied a snare, and thrust her into it.
And when she bade him bite the
cords and loose her, he reminded
her of his vows and of the fact that
the cords were of hide. Then the
raven, after long searching, came up
and found the doe in the toils, and
set to work to devise a remedy. And
when the day was dawning he said
to the doe “You swell out your belly,
and hold your breath, and when I
give the word, run for your life.”
Presently, the owner of the snare
came up, spear in hand, and, seeing
his quarry seemingly dead, loosed
her bonds. Upon which the raven
cawed loudly, and the doe, jumping
up, ran for her life. But the hunter,
seizing his spear, threw it after her.
And the spear missed the doe, and

girimaii fainânai mùi-khô thoinai
mon khâmânai, zongkhô hâiau
thunânai dinnânai phannî deoling
khô kheonânai fahâm-dang-man.
Ereau-nù daukhâi gâpnânai hùbâ,
mùii sikhângnânai dophong khâtâ,
mânsùii zongkhô lânânai, khubui
hoṭ-naire: khintu mùinî modomau
nângâlâbâ selnî modomau nâng-hùi-
naire. Beaunù selâ thoinaise.
Zapbai!

pierced the wicked jackal, who died.
And that's all!

Brai sâse ni khorâng.

Sâse brai dangman. Bî sân-se
hâgrâiau thâthî dân-nù thângbâ,
mosa mâse sùgùmnai khnânaise.
Ârù obânù bînî khâthî nî frai dau
mâse bîr-lâng-bâ, braii gîkhrong-
nânai bung-nâise “Âng nangkhô
manbâ, khugubân phurungauman.”
Bî be khorâng-khô-nù bungùi
thâdang, mosâ khnânânai “Be braii
mâ khithâdang? Ang bekhô mithinù
nângbai, ârù bekhô âng zâ-liâ-bù.
Erùi nungnânai braikhô mâthù¹⁵
hùnaise “Helùi brai, nanglai
mâthù¹⁶ khithâdang?” Theobù braii
khnâsongâlâbâ bî khorângkhônù
bungù ârù thâthî dânù. Obâsù
mosâii khâthî-âse-au fainânai, brai-

The Old Man and the Tiger.

There was once an old man, who,
when he was cutting reeds for his
fence in the jungle, heard a tiger
growling close to him; and it
happened that at that moment a bird
also flew away. On which the old
man, though he was in truth very
frightened, called after the bird “Ah!
if you had only stopped, I would
have taught you the secret of the
ghughu ban.” And this saying he
kept on repeating, so that the tiger
said to himself “What is it that the
old man is saying? I must get him to
tell me; and in that case I won’t
even eat him.” So he called to the
old man. “Look here, old man, what
is that about the *ghughu ban*?” But

khô bungnaise “Nang mâ khorâng bungdang, ângnù khithâibâ âng nangkhô zâgan.” Ereùi hanbâ brai gînânai “Nang gabun ângnî nâiau thâng. Oba âng nang-nù khithâgan.” Hanbâ, bî thângnaise. Okha naibâ, mosâiâ sùngùi sùngùi brai-nî nâiau phungaunù okhar fainaise. Phêre braiâ nunânai “Apâ, nang mau-nù thângnu lùì” hanbâ “Âng burobu thângâ. Nang-nî-au-sù mîa-nî khorâng sùlùngnù faidang. Obasù braiâ bungnâise “Âng nang hât-sing-bâ be khorâng-khô khithânu hâiâ. Ârù mîa-ne-sù lai-bau.” Ereùi bungbâ, bî thângnânai mîne mîthâm bîzang lâbonaise. Obasù braiâ mai dângrî set-lâi-au dîhonnaise. Dîhonnânai bî ghai mîthînai mosôkhô uthumai khamnânai mosôfùrkhô khânânai mai-mâran hùnaise. Hùbâ, boi uthumai zânai mosâiâ bungnaise “Abô, âng-hâ khârâ megem-sù dang.” Phê braiâ khithânâise; “râ-dâse, âbô, râ thâ, dânù zâsîsù,” hannânai, hù-ùi thânâise. Phêre unau mosâiâ khârâ megemnânai gaglai-sù-nânai thâbâ, phânsân gnâng lauthî lânânai gahâmùì thunânai hùnaise. Obâ mosâiâ “Abô! ângkhô mâ khâmù? Âng dinî thoisîgan!” Hanbâ, braiâ bungnaise “Nang mîa ghugubân sùlùngnù nâmaidangman bebaidî dukhu zânù hâiâbâ, âng nangkhô mîbrui

the old man, answering not a word, kept on chopping his reeds. Then the tiger crept up quite close to him, and said to the old man “If you don’t tell me what you are talking about, I will eat you!” But the old man, for all his fear, only said “You come to my house tomorrow, and I will tell you.” Very early the next morning the tiger asked his way to the old man’s house, and when he got there, it being still early morning, the old man said “And what may your honour be pleased to want?” And the tiger replied “I want to know what you were talking about yesterday.” But the old man replied “I cannot possibly teach you alone. You had better go and get two or three other tigers.” And so the tiger went away and returned with two or three of his brethren. In the meanwhile the old man had spread his unthreshed paddy in the yard. And, putting his earliest acquaintance first, he tied all the tigers to the post, round which the cattle revolve when they are treading out the grain, and set them to work to tread.

But the one in the middle, who was unaccustomed to such labour, cried out in a piteous voice that his head ached, and that he was getting very giddy. But the old man said “Wait a

fùrùngan?” Hannânai, ârù thù-khrâng thùsi khâmse. Obâsù mosâiâ bungnaise “Âng dukhu zâdang, be nunggo; nangnî khorâng khô âng mithiâkhui.” Hanbâ, braiâ bungnaise “Bîkhônù ghughubân hannânai bungu.” Obânù mosâ bungnaise “Âng mithîbai, zang-fùrkhô hogar dù!” Braiâ bungnaise “Râ, âru bângai mithî-zap-si-gan.” Hannânai, ârù hunaise. Unau mosâiâ brai-khô khulum-bai-nù homnaise. Phêre maiâ gâbâ bîsùr-khô hogâr-hot-naise. Hogâr-slâp-nù manâlâbâ, uthumai ârù bîsùrbù khâtlângnaise. Khât lângbâ, mengnânai, bîsùr dâpse au boibo zâ zânânai zirainaise. Obânù bîsùr boi didungkhô nunânai brainù hùnùlâgi railainaise “Be dîdungkhô hùâbâ, bî mobâbâ zang-fùr-khô sinai mangan.” Bungnânai, bîbù bungù “nangthâng.” Brainî sinnainai mosâiâ thâng-nâng-naise.

Obâsù bî thùrthùr bùrbùr gînânai thângdang, âru brai-nî nâ man-hùinânai, brainù didung-khô zâsi¹⁷ hubâ, braiâ bungnaise: “Manâbai; âng udubai. Âng onkhâtliâ. Inzur-goblong-thing hot.” Han-bâ, mosâiâ lânzâiâ zang didung-khô hotnaise. Obânù, braiâ sekhâ lânânai lânzaikhô dân-so-naise. Beaunù mosâiâ gâp-khrau gâpsî khâtlângbâ, braiâ bungnaise “Ârù ângghâ sâse

bit, my friend; you haven’t learned yet.” And when the tiger complained again, the old man fetched his goad and pricked him sore, so that, giddy and stumbling, he had to go round and round, and when the tiger said “I shall die at this rate,” the old man replied “You wanted to learn the *ghughu ban* yesterday, and unless you endure this trouble, you cannot possibly learn;” and, so saying, pricked him the more cruelly. Finally, the tiger said “If so be, I must be in pain, I must be. But I don’t see what it is all about.” Then the old man replied “This is precisely what they called the *ghughu ban*.” Then the tiger said “I see, I see, now let us go. We have learned our lesson.” But the old man said “Wait a bit, the paddy is nearly trodden out,” and would not stop pricking the tigers for all their entreaties. And when the paddy was all threshed, the old man began untying their bonds. But before he had finished, the tigers were in such pain that they tore the rope out of his hands and ran away. When they stopped to rest, they saw the old man’s rope, and said to one another “If we do not give the old man his rope again, we shall get into further trouble.” So, after much debate, the first tiger was deputed to take it back.

âgùì sing-sing hù-siù-lâng-dang!
Nang khâtnânai mêu-thu gonù?” Be
bîbaidinù khârùi khârùi naifinnânai
rau khôbù nuekhai, zirainaise, ârù
khânkhrai gurungau dùi nunânai,
khândâ lânzai-khô sunânai zânaise.
Phâre khânkhraiâ onkhâtrânai
lânzaiau khepnaise. Obânia mosâiâ
“Gomâ gomânu brainî bîgúiâ fai-
mât-dang;” hannânai, bînîfrai khîbù
khîsât khâtlângnaise. Obâsù zesenu
khârù khânkhraiâ gaglaigan
nungnânai, gahâmùì khep-sin-lângù.
Bebaidinù khârùi khârùi mosâiâ
thoifrâmnai zânaise. Unau
bongfâng-fùr-au nânagnânai âgârbâ,
obâsù mosâiâ gahâm zânaise, ârù
brai-bi-gùi-khô thângbai nunânai,
khâm dùi zânaise. Zapbai!

So back he went, trembling with
fear in every limb, and, getting close
to the old man’s house, offered him
his rope. But the old man said “It is
night, and I am in bed. I can’t come
out. Put the rope in at the window.”
So the tiger put it on his tail and
thrust it in at the window. But the
old man had his knife ready and cut
the tiger’s tail off. On which the
tiger once more fled, howling with
pain. But the old man shouted after
him “You may run as far as you
like, but my brother is after you, and
will catch you.” On which the tiger
ran faster than ever. At last,
however, he stopped to rest near a
cool pool of water, and, not seeing
the old man’s brother, dipped the
wounded stump of his tail into the
pool for refreshment. But a crab,
which dwelt in that pool, nipped the
stump of his tail; and the tiger
crying “The old man’s brother has
caught me!” again fled through the
jungle, and it was not till the crab
was knocked off against the trees
that he at last rested. And that’s all!

Mùkhrâ ârù Sessâ nî Khorâng.

Mâse sessâ ârù mùkhrâ zang fisikhi man. Bîsùr sânuì zang ozainù lùgùse thâiù, lùgùse zâiù, ârù lùgùse thâbaibaiù. Obâsù sânsê sâse Darrangârùì mânsuì goe thâlît lânânai, âlâsî zânù thângnai nâmau lùgù mannânai, bîsùr railainaise “Be mânsuì-nî goe thâlît-fùr-khô zânù lâgî zangfùr buddî manse khâmnu nânggô,” hannânai, sessâ-khô nâmau-nù thânu thinnânai mùkhrâia hâgrâ-iaù hâkhmânai thânaise. Phâre mânsuîâ manfaibâ, sessakhô nunânai, bîbân dinnânai, hùsùnaise. Hùsùbâ, mùkhraia hâgrânîfrai mâmâr onkhâtnânai thâlît-fùr-khô lânânai bongfângau gâ-khù-huinaise. Ârù “sessâ-faigan” hannânai, thâlît goe-fùr-khô mâmâr zâ-grùnaise. Ârù thâlît bigùr buâ sessânù dinnaise.

Emphâre unau sessâkhô mânsuîâ homnu hâiâkhùise ârù unau nâiaù thâng-phâ-phin-naise. Obâsù sessâiâ gâbzrî-ùi gâbzrî-ùi thângnânai, fisikhi-khô lùgù man-huì-nânai, gur thâlît bîbâ, thâlît bigùr bùa hùnaise. Bînîkhai sessâiâ brâpnânai “Bekhô bângai dukhu hùgan,” monau

The Tale of the Monkey and the Hare.

A monkey and a hare were great friends. They lived together, ate together, and walked about together. One day they saw a man from Darrang going to a feast and bearing plantains and betel-nuts, and they said to one another that they must contrive some plan to get hold of his load. So the monkey sent the hare to wait on the road, but himself hid in the jungle. And when the man came up and saw the hare sitting on the road, he put down his load, and ran after him. No sooner had he done so, than the monkey came and carried off the plantains and betel-nuts into a tree, and, for fear the hare should return, ate them all up in a great hurry, keeping only the skins of the plantains for his friend.

But when the man found that he could not catch the hare, he gave up the chase, and went home disconsolate; and so the hare went back, searching for his friend, and shouting his name. But when he found him and demanded his share of the spoil, the monkey offered

nungnânai, thâsobâre singau
thâhùnaise. Unau mukhrâiâ
bongfângnîfrai onkhâtnânai: “Sikhî
lùi! sikhî lùi! hanùì hanùì gâbzrî
gâbzrî thângbâ, sessâiâ brâpnânai
bungnaise “Mâthù sikhî-sikhî lui!
Âng beaunù razânî khuser ne-fai-
dang. Nangnù ângkhô mânù
nânggô?” Obâsù mukhrâiâ nu-
zâhùinânai bungnaise “He sikhî!
khuserkhô ângnù thâse ù, herâ! Bese
gathâu âng zâ-nai-nî;” hanbâ, sessâ
bungnaise; “Âng nang-nù hùnù hâiâ.
Razâ khnâbâ ângkhô bugan.”
Theobù bì embrâ-brâ-bînaikhai “Zâ
lùi zâ, âng nangzang hâ-liâ”
hannânai, zânù hùnaise. Phâre bì
zânânai, sâlâiau mânbâ “Sikhî âng
thoinaise” hannânai, bâbrâpbaibâ,
sessâ bungnaise “Nang gagainù
dukhu mandang. Âng dâ nangkhô
mâ khâmgan?” hannânai, bere jâthâ
nî bâhâ singau thâ-hùi-naise.
Mùkhrâ bù un un gâbzrînânai
thângnânai âru nu-zâ-hùi-nai-sui-
lâiù “Sikhî nang mâ khâm-
dang, herâ” bungbâ, sessâ khithânai
“âng razâ nî zâthâ nedang” hanbâ
“Sikhî, ângnù bângai dâmnai-nù hù,
herâ!” Sessâiâ bungnaise “Uh âng
hâiâ, herâ; râzâ khnâbâ ângkhô
buthâtgan,” bungbâ bù, embrâbrâ
“Âng lâsui-sù dâmgan, herâ,”
hannânai, bere bâhâkhô âkhâi-phât-
ne zang bu-zâp-naise. Obânu berefrâ
mukhâng, megon, modom gasenù ot

only the skins of the plantains, and
the hare, in his rage, said that he
would have his revenge. So, first of
all, he went and sat very quietly
under some *kachu* plants. Then the
monkey climbed down from the tree
and began crying “My friend! my
friend!” and the hare replied “Who
are you calling friend? I am
watching the king’s sugarcane field.
What do you want?” Then the
monkey came forth and said “Ah,
my friend, give me a little of the
cane to suck.” But the hare said “I
cannot give you any. If the Raja
were to hear, he would beat me.”
But as the monkey grew
importunate, he said “Eat, then, if
you will, and don’t blame me.” But
when he ate, the acrid juice of the
kachu caught his tongue, and he
rolled on the ground howling. But
the hare only said “It’s your own
fault. I told you not to.” Then he
went and sat beneath a wasps’ nest.
And the monkey, moaning and
complaining, followed him and
asked him what he was doing there,
and the hare replied that he was
watching the king’s cymbals. “Let
me play on them, only a little!”
entreated the monkey. But the hare
said “I daren’t do it. The Raja would
kill me.” “I will only play very
gently,” said the monkey, and,
prevailing by means of his

phop-bâ mùkhrâiâ gâp-khrau gâp-sî
bâbrâp-bai naise. Obâniâ sessâiâ
bungnaise: “Âng dù-hùi-nù nang-nù
khithâ-dangman, theobû nang kho-
râng lâia. Âng mâ khâmgan?”
hannânai, ârù dâpseau zîbô-gowâl-
nî khâthîau thâ-hùi-naise. Azùnghâ
mùkhrâ bù khîthû khîthû thângnânai
bungnaise “Ârù beau lai nang mâ
khâm dang, herâ?” Sessâ bungnaise
“Âng razâ-lùnghâ-nî¹⁸ sâmbâ-lauthî
nedang, herâ.” Bungbâ “Sikhî, âng-
nù bù hù, herâ! âng bângai dângnai-
nî!” Bî “hùâ” hanbâbù, embrâ-brâ,
dangnainânai, beaubù bî zîbô-zang
oṭ-zâ-naise. Bînfrai sessâ
thângnânai photobâreau thâ-hui-
naise. Mùkhrâ bù gâbzrî gâbzrî
thângnânai, ârù lùgù lâ-hùi-nânai
sessâ-khô sùngbâ, bi bungnaise:
Bekhônù razânî dolâ hannânai
bungù. Mùkhrâ bungnaise: “Sikhî,
âng bângai uthî-nai nî, herâ!”
bungbâ “Uh! âng hùnù haiâ. Razâ
khnâbâ, âng-khô mâ bunggan? Nang
mâbâ âbrâ mânsùi, herâ! Khorâng
khithâbâ-bù khnâsonggâ,”
bungbâbù, mùkhraiâ “Nonggâ, herâ,
sikhî dâse buâ uthîgan” hannânai,
phâtâbâreau bêt-drumbâ, gâdâhâ
lâgi thrùp thângnaise. Obâsù sessâ
khithânai “Duhui thâlit zânânai
bîgur hùnaiâ, benù, herâsikhî, nang
beaunù thâ-dù! Âng nangkhô
khulumbai! âng thângnaise”

importunity, clapped his hands on
the wasps’ nest and broke it, and
straightway the wasps stung his
mouth and face and body all over,
so that he rolled on the ground
crying out in agony. But the hare
only said “I told you not to, and you
would not listen, what could I do?”
And then he went away to where a
gowal snake lay. And again the
monkey followed him, and asked
what he was doing there. And the
hare said that he was watching the
king’s sceptre. “Ah! let me brandish
it, do,” said the monkey, and for all
the hare’s warnings would seize the
sceptre. Whereby he got bitten, and
was in greater pain than ever. Then
the rabbit went away and sat down
on a marsh, and the monkey
followed him once more, crying as
he went, and when he again
questioned his friend, the hare said:
“This is what they call the king’s
litter.” “Let me sit on it for a
moment,” said the monkey. “I can’t
do it,” said the hare, “what would
the king say? I think you are a fool,
my friend. I tell you not to do things
and you will persist.” But the
monkey did not listen to him and
jumped on to the marsh and stuck
miserably in the mud. And then the
hare said “Now, my friend, you give
me plantain skins to eat, do you?
You can stay where you are. I wish

hannânai, bî mu-khrâ-khô beaunù
gâr-lai-naise.

Obâsù unâu bîthîng gândâ mâse
fainai nubâ, bîkhô mukhraiâ
dikhâng-nù thing-dangman. Gândâiâ
bungnaise “Âng-hâ ukhui-sù-dang
ârù dùì-gâng-sùì-dang: âng nangkhô
dikhângnù hâiâ,” hannânai, bî
thângnaise.

Bînî unau ârù moesù mâse fainai-au
bîkhô bù khithâdangman Bîbù
khnâsongâlâbâ blot thângnaise.
Boinùkhrî khî-zap-au mosâ mâse
ukhui-sù-nânai bîthîng
thângdangman. Mùkhrâ nunânai
bungnaise “He âfâ, nang ângkhô be
dukhu nî frai dikhângâbâ, ârù raubô
dikhângliâ.” Hannânai gahâmùì
khulumnù homnaise. Theobù bî
“Âng nangkhô dikhângnânai mâ
mangan?” hannânai, khozo-ne-sù¹⁹
thângbâ, mukhrâiâ bungnaise “Âfâ,
nang ângkhô be photobâre-nî-frai
dikhângnânai hâbrùfùrkhô sù-srâ-
nânai ângkhô nang zâ!” hanbâ, bî
ukhui-sû-nai-khai, be khorâng-au
khnâ-song-nânai, bîkhô bungnaise
“Âng nangkhô zânû mon gúiâ,
manâthù, bebaidî dukhuau
gaglainaikhô dikhângbâ, ângghâ
gahâm zâgan. Theobù nang gaigainù

you good-day. I am off.” And, so
saying, he left the monkey and went
his ways.

And first of all a rhinoceros came.
But when the monkey begged for
help, he said that he was hungry and
thirsty, and really could not stop; he
was very sorry; and, so saying, he
too went away.

And when a buffalo presently came,
the monkey addressed him, but he,
too, had other business, and went
away. Last of all there came a tiger,
who was extremely hungry, and to
him the monkey said, “My father, if
you do not help me out of this
scrape, I have no help left,” and
with such and such like words the
monkey entreated him. But the tiger
said “What good will it do me if I
help you?” and was going away,
when the monkey cried out “Father,
father, take me out of the dreadful
marsh, and then, if you like, clean
me and eat me.” And the tiger was
so hungry that he said: “It is not so
much that I want to eat you, but if I
rescue one fallen into such calamity,
it will be well with me hereafter.
However, as you yourself have
offered yourself to be eaten, I see no

zâsinânai hùnai-i-au, âng zânù
hâgo,” hannânai, bînî lânzai-khô
pholau hoṭbâ, mùkhrâiâ bînî
lânzâiau hombâ, dikhâng-bù-naise,
mù-khrâ khîthânâise “Âfâ nang
ângkhô dâniâ modom-fùr-khô
gahâmui susrâ, emphâre rânâ zâ,”
hannânai sândungau dâse zâbai
thâdangman. Ereaunu mosâ-iâ
phâtsething naineau, bî bongfângau
fât-drâp gâ-khù-naise. Mosâ bekhô
nunânai, brâp-nânai, bongfâng
guriaunù sânnê sânthâm nebai
thânâise. Beбайдî thânânai, unau
khugâ sînânai, hâthai hâzîzî
khâmânai, thoithî-nânai, thânâise,
ârù thâmfaifrâ khugâ-i-au brûng-
brûng han-lai-nù homnâise. Beaunù
mukhrâiâ ose ose thoi-mâtbai nung-
nânai bongfâng bîzô nî frai lâse lâse
onkhâtbùnânai âglâ lâse-i-hai lânzai
khugau sù-nai-grù-bâ-bù mosâ
mungbô khâmâkhuisse. Ârù unau
âtheng thângse sùnânai hùnai,
beaubù mungbô khâmâkhuisse.
Obâsù mùkhrâ bungnâise “Nang
ângnî âthengfùrkhô khrem-khrem
oṭnânai zâgauman, lânzai-khô
khrem khrem oṭnânai zâgauman,”
hannânai, rong zânânai: “Dâniâ
ângnî khârokhô-nù zâ,” hannânai,
khugau sùnânai hùbâ, obânù mosâiâ
khrem oṭ-khrep-naise. Thoibai!
Zapbai!

harm.” So saying, he stretched out
his tail into the marsh, and the
monkey, grasping it, was drawn out.
Then the monkey said: “Let me get
dry in the sun, and when I am a bit
cleaner, you can eat me.” And so
saying he sat him down in the sun
and waited. But presently the tiger
looked another way, and the
monkey slipped up a tall tree. But
the tiger, being in a great rage,
waited two or three days at the foot
of the tree. But, as the monkey
would not descend, he lay at the
tree’s root as one dead, and opened
his mouth with his teeth grinning,
and the flies came and buzzed in his
mouth, so that at last the monkey
thought that of a verity he was dead.
So finally he crawled down, and
slowly inserted his tail in the tiger’s
mouth. But the tiger never stirred.
Then he felt one of the tiger’s great
paws. But the tiger never stirred.
Then the monkey said “Ah, you
would scrunch my bones to make
your bread, would you?” and
danced about gaily, and cried “See if
you can eat my head now,” and, so
saying, he put his head in the tiger’s
jaws. And then the jaws closed with
a scrunch, and that was the end of
the monkey. And that’s all!

Khusung ârù Mùkhrâ.

Besur sâne zang fisikhi man. Sâse lâmbâiau thâbâ, sâse mânsùi gur thâli mairang bânânai lâbonai nûnaisê. Bîkhô nunânai mùkhrâiâ fisikhinù khithânai-sùi: “Helùi sikhî, nang beaunù zâbai thâ. Be fainai mânsûia bîbân dinnânai nangthângkhô hùsùbâ, nangthâng khât.” Erùi hannânai khusungkhô bî lâmbâ-au-nù dinnânai mùkhrâiâ hâgrâ singau hâpnânai ânda zânânai hâkhmânânai thânaishui obâ be mânsûiâ khâthi zâbâ, khusungkhô nunânai, bîbân dinânai, húsúnaisê. Obânú mùkhrâiâ hâgrâ nî frai onkhâtnânai be thâli ârù gur khô lângnânai bongfângau gâkhùhùinâisê. Unau be mânsûiâ khusung-khô manekhai, gaigainî nâ-i-au thâng-fâ-fin-naisê. Benî unau, khusungâ hâgrâ-nî-frai onkhâtnânai fisikhô nâmainânai man-nânai, thâlit ârù gur bînaisê. Khintu mùkhrâiâ thâlit zânânai bigur gazâ, gur zânânai, thinkli gazâ khusungnù hùnaisê. Beaunù khusungâ brâp-naikhai, bîkhô bongfângau dikhâng-lâng-naisê. “Nang âng-khô gur ârù thâlit zânai nudang-man. Beau mâ dang, nang gagainù nai.” Beбайдî

The Tortoise and Monkey.

A tortoise and a monkey were great friends, and as they were on the road one day, a man passed laden with plantains. And the monkey, seeing him, said “You go and wait on the road, and when the man pursues you, run away. And so the man put down his load (the monkey having hid in the jungle), and ran after the tortoise. Then the monkey came out of the jungle and took the plantains and molasses that the man bare, and climbed with them into a tree. Then the man, not being able to catch the tortoise, returned, and, not getting his things, went home. Then the tortoise returned and asked his friend for his share of the plantains and molasses. And the monkey offered him for molasses potsherds, and for plantains their skins only; and, when the tortoise insisted, the monkey got angry and hoisted his friend into the tree, saying “See for yourself, if any plantains or molasses be left.” And so he went away and left him. And he could not get down, and one by one various animals came under the tree, but

bungnânai mùkhrâiâ bongfâng-nî-
frai onkhatnânai thângnaise Phê
khusungâ beaunù thânânai onkhâtnù
haiâkhùise. Be bongfângnî sing-
thing baidi baidi omâ
thângdangman. Khintu raubô bîkhô
on-â-khùise. Unau, gânda brai mase
be thing thângbâ bî bîkhô
khulumnânai bungnaise “Âfâ, nang
ângkhô onbâ âng nangnî bîkhung
sâiau bêt-drùm-nù nâmâiù.” Beaunù
gândaia bîkhô onnânai thinnaise.
Thin-bâ, bî bêt-drùm-naise. Obânù
gânda-hâ zânzi bai-naise! Obânâ,
bîkhô khusungâ hâgrâ zang
khupnânai dinnânai, razânî nâau
thângnânai razâ zânai khâmflai
sing-au thâ-hùi-naise. Phâ zeblâ mel
khun khun zâdangman, obâ
khusungâ khîphînâise. Razâ bîkhô
khnânânai “Sùr khîphîdang? Khîthù
dân!” Beaunù boibô “Âng
khîphîâkhùi” hannânai bungnaise.
Ârù bebaiddinù khonnesuì khîphîni-
au, sâse mânsuìâ bîkhô razâ nî
khâmflai singau nuhoṭnaise.
Nunânai razânî sigângau bung-naise
“Âfâ, nangthâng âng-khô dân lâgi-
bù, âng manse khorâng khithânù
nâmâiù. Nangthângnî khâmflai
singau-nù mabâ mase dang. Âng
mithîgo bînù khîphîdang.” Phê
razâia nainânai, bîkhô nunânai,
khîthù dânù thinnaise. Obânâ khu-
sungâ bungnaise “Âfâ nang ângnî
khîthù dâ dân! Âng nangthâng-nù

could not help him. And last of
these came a very aged rhinoceros,
and the tortoise begged leave to
jump down on his back. And to this
the rhinoceros consented, and so the
tortoise leapt down, with such force
that he broke the old rhinoceros’
back. Then he covered up the corpse
with leaves, and going to the king’s
court, sat him down under the king’s
throne; and, when the royal council
was assembled, the tortoise sneezed
loudly, “Who dared to sneeze?” said
the king. “Cut off his nose!” But
they all with one accord declared
that they had not sneezed, and, after
he had sneezed once or twice again,
some one saw the tortoise under the
king’s throne. So he said
respectfully “If your Majesty
wishes, you can kill me, but I have
something to say: There is some
living thing under your Majesty’s
throne. Without doubt, it was that
which sneezed.” On which the king,
looking under his throne, saw the
tortoise, and ordered them to cut off
his nose. But the tortoise said “Do
not cut off my nose, and in return I
will give your Majesty a
rhinoceros.” And at first the king
was angry, but for his entreating
gave him men with him to fetch his
rhinoceros, and when the men
returned with the body of the
rhinoceros, the king was very

gândâ mase hùgan.” Beaunù razâiâ
brâpnânai, bîbînai-baidi-nù mînsù
zâbrâ bî zang hùnânai hotnaise. Bî
thângnânai, gânda-khô boi bongfang
guriau khithî-hui-naise. Mînsùifur
gândâkhô lâbonânai, razânî singau
hùbâ, razâ hontoh zânânai bînù
gorai mase hùnaise.

Be gorâiau uthînânai khâtbaibâ,
mùkhrâiâ nunânai sùng-bâ, bî
bungnaise “Be goraikhô ângnù
razâiâ hunai.” Obânù bî sùngnaise
“Mâbrùî razâiâ nangnù hùnai?”
Beaunù bî khithânai, “Nang
ângkhô zî bangfâng sâiau gâr-bu-
dangman; âng beaunù thânânai,
lâmâkhândâ mase-nî sâiau
bongfâng-nî-frai bî-drûmbâ, bî
thoinaise. Unau âng bînî sâiau zâbrâ
zigâp hung-nânai hùsinnânai bîkhô
dinnânai razânî sigâng-au gânda nî
khorâng khithânai. Beaunù razâiâ
ângnù hontoh zânânai, be goraikhô
hùdang.” Beaunù mùkhrâiâ bî
khithânai baidî khamnaise. Râjâiâ
bîkhô nunânai brâpnânai khîthû
dânnaise. Zapbai!

pleased, and gave the tortoise a
horse.

And as he was riding off, he met the
monkey and told him that the king
had given him the horse. And when
the monkey asked him why, he said
that he had jumped on to a common
lizard from the tree, on which the
monkey had left him and had killed
it. And that then he had covered it
up with leaves and told the king it
was a rhinoceros. And the king was
pleased and gave him a horse. So
the monkey killed a lizard, and went
and told the king it was a
rhinoceros, and got his nose cut off
for his pains. And that’s all!

*Bâmun deâru bînî sâkor nî
khorâng.*

Sâse Bâmun dangman, ârù bîbâ sâkor sâse dangman. Sâ-se sâne zang Bâmun nî bîhau-bikhunzù-nî nâiau thâng-nù-lâgi thâlit gur gâkhir sorai lânânai sâkhor-khô bân hùnânai, bîkhô khithânâise “Nang be thâlit-fùrkhô dâ zâ. Zâbâ ânghâ khîthù fâtse bù megon dang.” Erùì hannânai thânguì thânaise. Phâre unau boi sâkhorhâ mikhâm ukhui-bâ, thâlit-khô lânânai, thaise thaise bînù un-phât-si khithînânai, be-baidînù boibo-khô-bù zâ-thro-lâng-naise. Phâre unau bîsur dâpseau zirai-hùiba, Bâmun bîbânkhô nueâkhâi, sâkhor-nî sigâng-au sùngnaise “Bibânâ mâ zâkhù?” Obâ sâkhorâ bungnaise, âng dùkhùì-nù nangnù khithînânai bî thâlit-fùrkhô zâbai. Ârù dâ nang mânù sùng-dang?” Beбайдînù Bâmunâ bolo²⁰ hâekhai srî srî thânaise. Phâre besùr beaunù khâm song-zâ-nù-lâgi zothon khâmnâise, ârù beaunù nâ khâwai mâ-ne-sù mandangman. Bînî sâkhornù mâse bùa hùnânai, gâsenù Bâmunâ lânâise. Phâre zebâ khâm man-naise, sâne-bù zânù lâgi zodangman. Ereaunù sâkhorâ sùngnaise “Bâmun gohain, nâ

The Brahmin and his Servant.

There was once a Brahmin who had a servant. And one day when they were going to the house of the Brahmin's mother-in-law, the Brahmin gave his servant a bunch of plantains and other things to carry, and said to him “Now, mind you don't eat those plantains, for I can see just as well behind as I can in front.” And, so saying, he marched ahead. And presently the servant, getting hungry, plucked one of the plantains from the bunch, and, holding it out to his master's back, ate it. And this he did again and again till all the plantains were gone. And when the Brahmin presently asked what had become of the load, the servant said “You told me you could see behind as well as in front. So I showed you each plantain before I ate it. And you never said anything.”

So the Brahmin went his ways speechless. Presently they stopped to cook their midday meal, and they had got with them a few *khawai* fish. But the Brahmin gave only one to his servant, and kept the rest himself. And when he was about to

khâwâiâ mâse bùâ daugâiù, nâ dùlù dùlù daugâiù?” Beaunù Bâmunâ bungnaise “Dùlù dùlù daugâiù.” Obâ bî bînî nâ mâsekhô bînî khâm-au khubui-hot-detnaise “Manâthù be hâtsing daugânù hâiâ, nang-ni zang dùlùse zâthang.” Beaubù gaigai-nî khorâng-zâng-nù zennânai bîkhô mungbâ bung-nù hâiâ khùise. Unau khâmkhô sâkhorâ hâtsing manzânâise.

Phâre bînifrai thânguì thânguì simli bîfâng dùlùse nunânai, Bâmun-khô sùngnaise “Bâmun gohain! be nunai bongfâng-frâ mâ bongfâng?” Bâmunâ khithânâise “*sirmolu*.” Sâkhorâ bungnaise: “Sirmolu nunggâ. Bîkhô hirmolu hanù.” Phâ obâsù phong-bâ phong-bâ sônù lâgi khorâng khâlâinaise. Phâre gurkhiâ dùlùse lùgù mannânai, bîsùrkhô sungbâ, “*himulu*” hannânai bîsùr bungnaise. Obânù sùngâ-hoâ-lâbâ Bâmunkhô phong-bâ sônâise.

Ârù bebaidi thânguì thânguì burmâ dùlùse nunânai sâkhorâ Bâmunkhô sùngnaise “Bâmun gohain, boi gângsù zâbai thânai zanthu-fùr mâ bungô?” Bâmunâ khithânâise “Bîfur sâg.” Sâkhorâ bungnaise “Nunggâ, bîfùr sâgoli.” Beaubù bîbaidinù

eat, the servant asked innocently: “Oh! Brahmin, do *khawai* fish swim about singly or in shoals?” To which the Brahmin said: “Why, in shoals, of course.” So the servant said “Then my fish had better go with yours.” And, so saying, he threw his fish on the Brahmin’s mess, which was defiled. So the Brahmin got no dinner, and the servant ate the whole.

A little later they came across a number of *simul* trees. Seeing them, the servant asked his master “And what do they call these trees, master?” And the Brahmin (being an educated man) said “These are *sirmolu*.” But the servant said “Not so, not so! These are *himulu*,” and offered to bet five blows that it was so. And, meeting some cowherd boys, he asked them what the trees were. And when they said “*himulu*” he gave the Brahmin five blows without further question.

Next they met a drove of goats. “And what may these be, Brahmin, these animals that are grazing?” And the Brahmin said “These be called *châg*.” But the servant cried “Not so, not so! These are *châgali*.” And the result, as before, was that the

Bâmunâ phongbâ sô-zâ-naise. Ârù
bînîfrai thângnânai dau-bả dùlùse
nunânai sùngnaise” “Bâmun gohain,
befur mâ dau?” Bâmunâ bungnaise
“Nang bîfurkhô mithiâ? Bîfurkhô
bog hanù.” Bî bungnaise “Mâ bog
hanù? Nunggâ. Bîkhô boguli hanù.”
Beaubù bebaidinù Bâmunâ phongbâ
sôzânaise. Unau bî manse slok
hannaise:

“Sâg sirmolu bog ba-kâran
Tinî pânch panra kîl sudâ akâran.”

Phâ bînîfrai thângnânai bihai-
bikhunzù nî nả khâthi manbâ,
sâkhorkhô thin-hot-grù-nânai
khithânaise “Nang thângnânai
mâmâr khâm songnù thin; manâthù
ângghâ mikhâm ukhui-sù-dang.”
Phâre bîbaidi-nù bî thângnânai,
Bâmun-nî bikhunzù-nù hângsù
bûthâtnânai sobai khâre zang
mikhâm songnânai dinnù
khithânaise, ârù bungnaise “Nangnî
nangzâ-mâdùîâ megong-au gabâp
nunggâbâ zâiâ.” Obâsù bî songnânai
dinnaise. Phâre unau bizâmâdùîâ so-
fai-bânù, mâmârùì khâm khutnânai
hunaise. Bizâmâdùîâ ukhui-sù-nai-
khai, khâm megong mungbo
bâsiâlâbâ zânù ngâng zânaise.

Brahmin was worsted and got five
blows.

And next they came across a flock
of paddy-birds, which the Brahmin
called “*Bog*,” but the servant
“*Boguli*.” And again he was worsted
and got his five blows. On which he
consoled himself by reciting an
Assamese saying, to the effect that it
is ill arguing with a fool:

“Sâg sirmolu bog ba-kâran
Tinî pânch panra kîl sudâ akâran.”

And when they were now come near
the Brahmin’s mother-in-law’s
house, and the Brahmin was become
very hungry, he sent his servant on
ahead to beg them to get supper
ready. So the servant went on ahead
and bade the Brahmin’s mother-in-
law cook a duck and put lots of
plantain ashes, which the Kachâris
use for salt, well knowing that his
master disliked its acrid taste. So the
duck was cooked with plenty of
alkali.

And when the Brahmin arrived, his
meal was set before him, and he was
so hungry that he had to eat it
whether he liked its savour or no.

Obâsù unau beбайдînù baidî baidî lâzi mannai zânaikhai, Bâmunâ bidânùlâgi sitti gângse lit-nânai sakhornî âkhâi-au hùnânai nâ-i-au hoṭnaise. Lâmbâ sâse thângbâ, beaunù litnù-grang sâse mânsùì lùgù mannânai, bînù sitti khithînaise. “Beau mâ litdang, âng-nù khithâ.” Obâsù, mânsùìâ sitti-khô nainânai, “Nangkhô dânù lâgi Bâmun nî bidâ-khô thindang” erui bungbâ, bî sitti-khô phisînânai bungnaise “Afâ nang ângnù gubun sitti gângse litnânai hù.” Ârù be sitti-au erehai lit: “âdâ, nangnî fisâ-hingzau zang be sâkhorâ man-hùi-bâ-nù hâbâ khâmnânai hù. Âng benifrai thângnânai bîsùr-nî hâbâ nunù nânggâ.” Beбайдinù be sitti-khô lângnânai Bâmun-nî bidânù hùnaise. Khintù bî sitti-khô nunânai, monau dukhu mansù-naise. Theobù, bigùi-nî khorâng gârnù hâekhai, fisâzù zang mâmbâr hâbâ khâmnânai hùnângnaise.

Phâre sânsê thânânai bî fainânai bidâ khô sùngbâ gâsenù khorâng khnânânai, bî sâkhor khô dânùlâgi srî srî upai khâmnaise. Be upaikhô sakhornî hingzauâ mithînânai, bekhô onnânai bînù khithînaise. Khithâbâ, hingzau zang hoṛau udunîau mosôfisâ mâse khâ-khrop-

And so in various ways the Brahmin was put to shame by his servant. So he wrote a long letter to his brother, and, putting it in his servant's hand, bade him deliver it. But he went a little way, until he met a man who could read and write, and he bade him tell him what was written in the letter. And the man read him the letter, which was to the effect that the brother was to kill the servant. On this, the servant tore up the letter and bade his friend write another one, saying “Dear brother, on receipt of this letter marry my servant to my niece without delay. I shall not be able to come to the wedding.”

Taking this letter, the servant went to his master's brother, who was much vexed, but dared not disobey. Accordingly, though reluctantly, he married the servant to his daughter.

And, when the master came to see if his servant had been disposed of, and heard what had happened, he set about to kill him. But his niece got to know of the matter and told her husband, who got a calf, and, binding it hand and foot, put it by her in her bed. And in the night the

nânai futhunânai dinnaise. Phâre
Bâmunâ fisâzù zang udubai thâdang
mon khâmnânai, srî srî thângnânai
mosôfisâ-khô dânnaise. Phâre sân-
sô-bâ mosâfisâkhô dânfnâng-nai
nunânai mâmârùi bizâmadui
sâkhorkhô gârhùinù lâgi thinnaise.
Khintu bizâmâduiâ bîsùrnî bâriâu
lângnânai, lânzâi dĩhonnânai,
fopnânai dinnaise. Unau Bâmunâ
mosâ bùthâtnai-nî nungge srî srî
uddhâr zânu lâgi gaminî
mânsùifùrkhô lingnânai phozù
hùdangman. Phâre mânsuifùr zânu
zobâ, sâkhorâ bâriâu thângnânai
mosô lânzai-khô bunânai bungnaise
“Bâmunâ mosobù bùthârâ-khùi
phozù-bù hùâ khùi, hùi-sù!” Beбайдĩ
bungbai-thâbâ, phozùnî mânsuifrâ
khnânânai, phozù zâiâkhùise.
Beбайдĩnù bîsùr uddhâr mânâkhùise.
Zapbâi!

Brahmin came, and thinking the calf
was his niece’s husband sleeping by
her side, killed it. And when he
found out his mistake in the
morning, and learned that he was
guilty of cow-killing, he bade his
niece’s husband go and bury the calf
in all haste. And the servant dragged
the calf into the garden and buried it
with its tail sticking out of the
ground. Meanwhile, the Brahmin set
to work to get himself purged of the
offence of cow-killing, and
summoned the villagers to a feast
without telling them why. And when
they were all seated, the servant ran
out into the garden and hauling at
the calf’s tail, called out “The
Brahmin didn’t kill a cow, Oh, no!
and

Âbrâ nî khorâng.

Sâse brai bùrùi dangman. Bî-sùr-hâ
sâse gâthâ dangman. Bî sânse brai-
bùrùi-ni-au mosô bainu lâgi thâkâ
bînaise. Khintu brai bùrùi gâthâkhô
âzlâ nunânai thâkâ hùâman. Gâthââ
embrâ-brâ bînai-khai thâkâ zakhai-

The Story of the Simpleton.

There was once an aged couple,
who had a foolish son, who one day
begged them to give him money to
buy an ox with. And, owing to his
persistence, though they knew him
to be simple, they gave him sixteen

brùi hùnaise. Phâre gâthâa mosô
bainù lâgi thângui thângui manthâm
âli-ni khâthi-au gahâm mosô mâse
nunânai, be âli-au thâkâ dinnânai
mosôkhô khânânai lâbonaise.
Thângui thângui bîhâ khînu on-
khânânai mosôkhô hâgra daise-au
khânânai dinnânai khîhùibâ mosôâ
bething khâtlângnaise, Phâre be
khînainîfrai fainânai mosôkhô
nuekhai hâgrâ hâgrâ nâmaibainaise.

Ârù bî mùi zonthrâ mâse nunânai,
bîkhônù bîni mosô hannânai,
hùsùbaie hùsùbaie unau mùiâ hâgrâ
zethap-au gongâ nângnânai
thâpthânânai thânaise. Obâsù bî
mùikhô gâdâiau dîdungzang
khânânai nâ hâ lâgi didung zorai
zorai nâ manfai-naise. Beaunù bîmâ
bîfâiâ sùngnaise “Nang mosô bainù
thângnaia, hùrù?” Obâsù bî
bungnaise “Be dîdungkhô bûbânù,
zangfùr mosô mangan.” Erù
hannânai sâthâm zang dîdungau
homnânai bûnaise. Bûi bûi mùiâ nâ
man-fai-bâ, boibù gî-khronгнаise.
Phâre bîmâ bîfâiâ mùi-khô
buthâtnânai mai salai-nù lâgi
gâmînmânsùinù bângan hùnaise.

Beaunù gâthâ âbrâiâ ai âfâiâ mosô
buthâtnai zâbai hannânai mâlainî
gâme gâme khithâbainaise. Khintu

rupees and let him go. And, as he
went, he found a fine ox grazing
where three roads meet; and, putting
his rupees down on the road, he
bound the ox and drove it away.
Presently, he stopped to rest, and
while he was dozing, his ox ran
away. So he began searching all
through the jungle for the missing
animal.

At last he found a fine stag, and
thinking that to be his ox, chased it
through the forest till by chance its
horns got caught in a thicket. So he
tied a rope round its horns, and to
that tied another rope, and so on till
he got home. And when his old
mother asked him if he had bought
his ox “Havn’t I, just,” said he, “just
help me to pull and see!” On this,
the three of them pulled at the rope,
hand over hand, and presently the
stag made his appearance kicking
and struggling, at which they were
mightily afraid. However, they
killed the stag, and gave of its flesh
to the neighbours to eat.

On which the simpleton went about
and told the villagers that they had
eaten of cow’s flesh. But,

bîkhô âbrâ nunânai mansùifrà bînî
khorâng khô fathiâ-khùise.

Bînî unau, âjî-bù thâiù kâli-bù-thâiù,
âbrâiâ bângai detbùnânai gâgainî
hingzau namainù lâgi ârú brai bùrùi-
nî-au thâkâ bînaise. Beaubù hùâ
gârâ, thâkâ zokhai-brùi brainîfrai
lânânai hingzau ânmainânai
thângnaise. Thângùì thângùì gâmî
mânsùì-nî dùi gathân-au zombai
thânaise. Phâre unau sâse mazâng
hingzausâ dùi lângnù fainai nunânai,
dùi gâthan-au bi lângnai
hingzausâkhô homnânai lâbonaise.

Phâre fai-ùì fai-ùì nâmâ-i-au
mengnânai bongfâng fângse nî
singau zirainaise, ârù mosô halwâ
mâse lânânai mânsùì sâse bù beaunù
ziraidangman. Bîbaidî bîsùr ziraibâ
thâbâ homnai lâng-zâ-nai
hingzausâiâ zingâsi-nânai gâbùì
gâbùì megon-dùiâ hâ-hâlâgi bùhi-
lâng-naise. Bîkhô nunânai mosô
lânai mânsùia âbrâ-nù khithânaise
“Nang be hingzau-sâ-khô mau
mannai? ârù nang bîkhô nainânai
lâbodang, na naiâlabâ lâbodang?”
Obâ âbrâiâ bungnaise “Ang bîkhô
mazâng nunânai bîsurnî dùi-gathân-
nî-frai thâkâ zokhai-brui dinnânai

fortunately, knowing he was a
simpleton, no one believed a word
he said.

Another time, when the simpleton
was grown a bit bigger, he again
begged money of his parents: this
time that he might get him a wife.
And since he would not take a
refusal, he got his sixteen rupees
and set out afresh in search of a
wife. Finally, he went and sat at a
place where the village women drew
water. And when a pretty maiden
came down with her vessel on her
hip to draw water, he seized her and
carried her off.

And when he got tired, he stopped
to rest under a tree. And it happened
that a man driving a plough ox was
also resting there, and the maiden
sat there crying her very eyes out for
grief at having been carried off. So
the man with the ox asked the
simpleton “Where did you get that
girl? Did you have a look at her
before you took her, or didn’t you?”
To which the simpleton replied “She
seemed a pretty girl, so I put down
sixteen rupees at the bathing place
and carried her off.” On which the
wise man said: “You must be blind.
The girl’s pretty enough, but don’t

lâbodang.” Obânú bî buddi grângâ bungnaise “Nang khânâ dang: be hingzausâ mazâng-bâ-bù, bînî megon thaine-â betnai. Nang nuakhùi nù? Honùì, dùìâ so so bùhîlângdang. Bîbaidi hingzausâkhô nang mâ khâmnu?” Be khorâng khnânânai âbrâiâ bînî mosô zang slainù nâmainaise. Khintu bî mânsuìâ misainù hùnù nâmâiâ. Theobù embrâbrâ bînaikhai: “lâ, le, lâ!” hannânai, mosôzang mânsuìsang slainânai, gâgai gâgai monau gahâm mannânai azang sâse azang sâse mâmâr thânglainaise. Beбайдînù thânguì thânguì âbrâiâ bongfâng fângse singau burmâ lânai mânsuì sâse zâbai thânai nunânai, bîbù beau-nù zânaise. Beбайдî zâbai thâbâ, mosôâ hâ-sudangman. Phâre bî burmâ lânai mânsuìâ bungnaise “Be mosô nî uduiâ goblongbai, ârù sâsê thâbâ be thoisigan. Beaubù bî âbrâiâ gomâ nungnânai, mosôkhô bînî burmâzang slainaise. Beбайдî thânguì, ârù sâsê thâlit lânai mânsuì beбайдî-nù bongfang singau zânai mânsuì lùgù mannânai, âbrâiâ bú zâdangman. Khintu burmâiâ gângsu ukhuinânai bâbrâp bainaiau bî zânu sukhu man-e-khai, burmâ khô bubâ, burmâ bâ bâ hannaïse. Obânú; “Ese mengnaiu âng nangkhô mâbrui bâgan?” hannânai, brâpnânai, gârnu lubuibâ, be thâlit lânai mânsuìâ, thâlit khô âbrânù hùnânai bî burmâ

you see that both her eyes are burst. You clearly don’t see straight. Just see how the water is flowing from both her eyes.” On hearing this, the simpleton offered to exchange the girl for the ox. But the other pretended to be unwilling, till, after much persistence on the part of the simpleton, he cried: “There, take it, take it!” So the exchange was effected, and each went on his way mightily satisfied.

And, as the simpleton went his ways, he found a man seated under a tree having a goat with him. So he too stayed to rest. And when they stopped to rest, the ox lay down to rest. On this, the man with the goat said: “That ox is not a good bargain. It will die in a day or two.” And the simpleton, believing this, exchanged the ox for the goat. And when he set forth again, he met a man carrying a big bunch of plantains. So the two sat down. And as the goat was restless and gave him no peace, the simpleton began beating it, so that it cried Ba! ba! (now *Ba* in the Kachári speech means “carry”). So he said “Do you suppose a tired man like me is going to carry you?” And he was so angry that in disgust he exchanged the goat for the bunch of plantains; and went on. And as he went, he met a man cracking his

khô lăngnăise. Bĩbaidĩ nũ bĩsũr
bĩnĩfrai thănglăinaise. Ereaunũ sâse
mănsũi bĩnĩ sigăng-thing âsĩ khrep-
khrep²¹ dămnănai faidang. Obăsu
khăthiau lùgũ manbă âbrăiă bung-
năise “Ăng burmă măse mănĩ
hũnănai be thălit-khũ, lăbodang.
Theobũ ângnău thălit bĩũ?” Erũ
hannănai “nang thălit zănũ
lubuidang-bă nang-nĩ bidyăkhũ
ăngnũ hũ;” hannănai, bĩ biaunũ
hurăsemăni sũlũngnănai, zenthe-nũ
hănănai, thălit-khũ bĩnũ hũnănai âsĩ
khrep khrep dămnănai thăngnăise.
Thăngũi thăngũi, mai gezer dăpseau
khĩnũ onkhătnănai khĩnaiau bĩnĩ
bidyăkhũ baugărnăise. Ărũ be mai
gezeraunũ gamăbai hannănai,
maikhũ themă nainaibaidĩ nainaise.
Beaunũ mainĩ girimaiă mai hăbai
thădangman, nũnănai, bĩkhũ
sũngnăise “Nanghă beau mă
gamădang? Ăngnĩ mai-fũră hămă
zăthrobai!” Ăbră bungnăise “Ănghă
thăkă zokhai-brũi nĩ bidyă manse
beaunũ gamăbai. Nang bũ âng zang
namai-phă-bă, âng nangkhũ gahăm
mangan,” hannaikhăi, bĩ bũ nămaiũi
nămaiũi, manekhăi brăpnănai:
“nang nĩ khorăngă misă,” hannănai,
ăsi dămbă: “Ăfă, dă âng manbăi;”
hannănai âbrăiă khătlăngnăise.

Ărũ bebaidĩ thăngũi thăngũi fukuri
manse manhũibă beaubũ bĩ khĩnănai

fingers, and, thinking he did it in
scorn of his plantains, explained at
what price he had got them.

However, he offered to give him the
plantains if he would teach him the
art of cracking his fingers. So the
two stayed there a long time till the
simpleton had more or less acquired
the art he coveted. Then as he went
on, he suddenly forgot what he had
learned. And because he forgot it in
a paddy field, he thought he must
have lost it in the paddy, and began
examining the ears of paddy as a
woman searches another woman’s
hair for lice. And when the owner of
the field came up and asked what he
was about, he said: “I have lost a
thing which cost me sixteen rupees.
Come and help me to look.” So the
two looked together, and when, after
much search, they found nothing,
the other man, in pure vexation,
cracked his fingers. On which the
simpleton, crying “I’ve found it!
I’ve found it!” went dancing away.

Presently, he stopped by a tank, and
again forgot his new acquisition. So

bînî bidyâ khô baugârnaise. Phâre bî
nâmaie nâmaie manâkhùi. Ereaunù
sâse mânsùi lùgù mannânai
sùngnaise: “Nanghâ beau ma
gamâdang?” hanbâ; “Âfâ, ânghâ
beau gahâm basthu manse gamâbai,
nangbù namaibâ, âng gahâm
mangô;” bungnai-au bîbù bîzang
namaifânâise, ârù unau nâmaiùi
nâmaiùi hâbru zang musunlâ-
musunlî zânânai, theobù manekhai,
bî mânsùiâ brâpnânai âsi dâmnâise.
Obâ bî “ô âfâ, dâsù âng bekhô
manbai!” hannânai, rong zânânai,
nâ-hâ-lâgi khrep-khrep dâmnânai nâ
manhúinaise. Bikhô nunânai brai
bùrùiâ minî-sù-naise. Agla bîkhô
sinai manâkhùiman, unau sùngnânai
mithînaise. “Ârù thâkâfurâ mâ
khâm-khù?” hanbâ, bungnaise “Âng
hingzau sâse lâbodangman, Behâ
megon thaine bù betnai. Bînîkhai
ârù mosô slainâise, Bihâ bù udui
goblong zânai, ârù burmâ mâse zang
bîkhô slainâise. Bîbù ângkhô bânù
thinnaikhai brâpnânai, thâlit
slainâise. Thâlit khô nunânai, sâse
mânsùiâ bînaikhai, be mânsùinîfrai
be bidyâ khô sùlùngnânai thâlit
hùnani lâbodang. Ârù âng mâ
khâmnù nânggò?” Zapbai!

he plunged into the mud to look for
it. And a man came up and asked
what he was searching for? To
which he replied “My friend, my
friend! I have lost something very
valuable. Do come and help me to
look.” On which, the two searched
until they were covered with mud;
and when they found nothing, the
new-comer cracked his fingers in
vexation, and the simpleton, crying
“I’ve found it! I’ve found it!” went
gaily cracking his fingers all the
way home. And when his father and
mother saw him, they smiled at his
state, and till they spoke to him did
not know who he was. And then
they asked him what he had done
with his money. “Oh!” said he, “first
of all I bought a lovely maiden, and,
because her eyes were bad, I
exchanged her for an ox; and
because there was something wrong
with the ox, I got a goat in
exchange; and because the goat
wanted me to carry him, I got angry
and changed him for plantains. And
the plantains I gave to a man who
taught me to crack my fingers, and
what else would you have me do?”
And that’s all!

Sâ-snî âbrâ nî khorâng.

Sùrbâ âbrâ sâsnî dangman. Bîsùr sâ se dâpseau onkhâtlâng-nai-au nâmâ-au-nù dùì-slùng bângai mannânai bîkhônù mâbrùi bângan hannânai khorâng zâlai-naise. Beaunù bîdâ gederâ bungnaise “Boibù zânzî khâphrâ-nânai bânù nângbai,” hannânai, boinùkhri bî âglâ zânânai, bînh khithîau sâse hom-hù-naise. Beбайдî-nù bînh zânziau bî, bînh zânziau bî homlainânai dùìslungau sânsrilainaise. Beaunù âtheng-mani zerbâ-mâni sânsrinai-au thoi onkhâtlainaise. Phâre beбайдînù zenthen ùi bânkhângnânai bîdâ gederâ sâse-se lângkhâtbai nung-nânai sâ-naise. Sânnânai sârâ bùâ mannaise. Ârù unau bînh godâiâ sânnaise. Bî bù sâ-râ bùâ mannaikhai, sâfrimbù khonse khonse sânnânai sârâ bùâ mannai. Bînhkhai boibù sâse lângkhâtbai hannânai zingâsî-nânai khorâng zâzlaibai thâdangman. Ereaunù bething Bâmun sâse thângnânai besùrkhô nunânai sùngnaise: “Gotho-fùr nung-sùrhâ mâ zâdang?” Bîsùr bungnaise “Âfâ, zangfùr bîdâ bîfong sâsnî man. Dâ be dùisâ bân-

The Story of the Seven Simpletons.

There were, once upon a time, seven simpletons. And once they were going down the road, and meeting a puddle, were in great distress as to how they should cross it. And the eldest said “I will go first, and you all follow, holding one another’s loin cloths.” So they held one another’s cloths and crawled through the puddle on their hands and knees, getting very muddy and dirty in doing so. But when they had fairly got across, the elder set to work to count; and, as he failed to count himself, behold, there was one missing. Then the next brother counted; and, as he, too, found one missing, they each in turn counted. And so it became clear that one was lost; and there they stood debating this deplorable business. Just then a wily Brahmin came up, and asked what was the matter. And they told him that they had been seven, but that in crossing the puddle, one of them had been lost. On which, the Brahmin, quickly counting them, found that they were still seven, and, judging them to be simpletons, said to them “My sons, if you will

naiau zangfùrhâ sâse lăngkhâtbai.
Bînîkhai beaunù zangfùr zingâsi-lai-
bai thădang,” hannaikhai Bămunâ
srî srî sânnânai sâsnî khôbù nudang.
Bînîkhai bî “Besùr âbrâ zânù
nănggô” nungnânai, besùrkho
khithânai, “Găthăfùr, nangsùr
ăngnî năi-au bùi bă, âng nangsùrnî
mănsùikhô đihonnânai hùnù hăgan,”
hannaikhai, bîsur mănthî zânai.
Unau Bămun goe khândisnî
khaunânai bîdă gedernî âkhâiau
hùnânai “Be goe-ă-khândi bese
dang, nang sâ.” Hanbă, bî sânnanai
khândî snî mannâise. Beaunù
Bămună bungnai: “Nangsùr be
goekhô rănlainânai ză,” hanbă,
rănnai-au găgai găgai grup-gaglai-
nai. Beaunù bîsur rong zânânai
Bămun-nî năiau bùi nò-lăgi Bămun
zang thăng-fă-nai.

Phăre bebaidînù sânnesù thănnânai
sânse bîsùrkhô băriau megong
dăngnù lăgi thîn-năise. Âru Bămun-
hă sâse fisătlă dangman. Bîkhôbu
bîsùrzang hùnânai khithânai,
“ăngnî fisătlă-iă bù nangsùr zang
megong dăng-thang, ârù un ză-lăng-
bă bîkhô thutlun-thutlân lăngfă.”
Erui bungbă bîsùr băriau thăngnânai
megong dănghuidang. Phăre unau
Bămun-nî fisătlăiă un zălăng-nai.
Beaunù bîkhô nunânai bîsùr
railainai “Dùhùi bîfă khithă-

come to my house and work for me,
I will find you the missing man.” To
which with one accord they agreed.

Then the Brahmin split a betelnut
into seven pieces and put them into
the hand of the eldest. “Now count
them,” said he, “and tell me how
many there be.” And he counted and
found that there were seven. “Now
take each man a piece,” said the
Brahmin, and, behold, to each piece
there was a man. So in great joy and
peace of mind they went to the
Brahmin’s house to work.

And then, one day, he sent the seven
simpletons out into the garden to
weed the vegetables, and with them
he sent his only son, saying “If the
lad is lazy and falls behind, shove
him along and make him work.”

So they all went into the garden and
began cutting the weeds with their
knives; and presently the boy fell
into the rear. On which they said
“There is that Brahmin boy fallen
behind. Did not his father say that

dangman “gǎthǎ un zālāngbā bīkhô
thutlun thutlân lāng,” hannânai, dâ-
nī-au zangfūr mǎ khāmgan?”
Beaunù bīdā gederā “Bebaidīnù
khāmnù nānggô,” hannânai,
sāfrimbu bī khonse, bī khonse,
megong dāngnai sekhār zang
thunânai hūnânai. Bamun-nī
gǎthǎkhô būthātñânai dinnaise.
Phāre unau megong
dāngkhāngnânai nǎiau faibā
Bamunā sūngnǎiau khithānaise
“nang khithānaibaidi zangfūr bīkhô
sekhār zang thunai-au bī thoinânai
thābai.” Phāre Bamunā sī sī
thānaise.

Ārū sānse hāli oinù thinnânai
bungnaise “Nangsūr gābun simli sâ-
i-au hāli oinù thāngnù nānggan.”
Phāre unau bīsūr fungzāni
sikhāngnânai nāngal mosô fāgā
lānanai simlifāng guriau thāngnânai,
simli sâ-i-au khaise gākhūnaise, ārū
khaise hā-i-au thānânai mosôkhô
fāgā zang khānânai hūbā, sâ-i-au
thānaifrā bū-khū-lāng-naise. Beaunù
dīdung zǎ-i zǎ-i hāli snī mosô²²
gāsēnù thoi-thrā-naise. Unāu nǎ-i-au
fainânai bīsūr Bāmunnù khithānaise
“Zangfūr simlī sâ-i-au mosô dī-
khāng-nū hāekai hāli oinù
hāiakhuise.” Bamunā “mosôfrā mǎ
zākhū?” Hanbā, “thoi-thrā-bai,”
khithānaise. Bāmunā unau mung-bō

we were to push him along? What is
to be done now? But the elder
brother said, “Do? Why, do as we
were told.” On which each of them
hit him with his weeding knife, so
that presently he died. And when the
weeding was quite finished, they
went and told the Brahmin, saying
“You told us to shove him along,
and as we had our knives in our
hands, we hurt him so that he died.”
But the Brahmin was speechless, for
they had but done as they were told.

Another day he told them to go and
plough. “Take your ploughs up
above the great *simul* tree,” he said.
So they rose in the early morning,
and, taking ploughs, cattle and
ropes, went to the great *simul* tree.
And some stayed below and bound
the ploughs and cattle with the
ropes, and others climbed the tree
and hauled. But the ropes broke and
the cattle were killed and the
ploughs were smashed. And then
they went and told the Brahmin that
they had tried to plough *above* the
simul tree and had failed. “And what
of the cattle?” said he, “Oh! they
fell down and were killed,” they
replied. So, in despair, he bought

upai mane zânânai ârù mosô
bainânai bîsùrkhô hâli oi-hù-naise.

Phâre mai mannai-au mai hânânai
unau Bâmunâ dângri khaie khaie
hùnânai bîsùrkhô rùgânù thinnaise.
Beaunù bîsùr maikhô mau dinnù
hannânai sùngbâ, Bâmunâ
bungnaise “Bùrùiâ zerùi din-nù
thin-ù, beau-nù din,” hanbâ, bîsùr
thângnânai, bùrùi-khô sùng-hùi-
naise. Bùrùiâ nâ-nî hâbâfùr
khâmna-i-au monau brâpnânai
thâdangman. Beaunù bî bungnaise
“Mai din-nù thaùni manâbâ, ângnî
khorô-au-nù dinfai!” hanbâ, bîsùr
boibo mai bibân zang bùrùi-khô hù-
sin-thrâ-naise. Bîbaidî-nù gâsenù
mai rùgânânai bînî sâiau dinnaise.

Phâre manâbâ Bâmun dublî nî frai
fainânai bùrùi khô nâmaibâ bîsùr
khithânai “Ângnî khârâ-au-nù mai
din han-nai-khai zangfur mai zang
hu-sin-nânai dindang.” Biaubù braiâ
mungbô upai mane zânânai, bùrùi
khô fopnù lâgi bîsurnù hotnaise.
Phâre bîsùr bùrùi-khô khânânai oâ
sing sing bageding-bagedâ bân-
lâng-nai-au bùrùiâ oâ thânai-au
nângnânai siri-lângnaise.

other cattle and sent them out to
plough afresh.

And when the harvest was ripe, they
reaped the paddy, and, tying it in
sheaves, brought it home and asked
where they were to put it. And the
Brahmin said “Put it where my old
woman tells you to put it.” So they
went and asked the Brahmin’s wife.
But she was very busy, and only
cried “Oh, bother you and your
paddy! Put it on my head!” On this,
they all took their sheaves, and
heaped them on the old woman, so
that she died. And when the
Brahmin came from his work and
asked for his old woman, they said
they had buried her in the paddy, as
she told them to. On which, being at
his wit’s end, he bade them go and
bury her. On this, they tied the
corpse on a bamboo sledge and
bumped it along through the
bamboo-clump, so that it got
knocked off by the way.

And when they came to some fallow
land, they dug a grave, and then
began looking about for the corpse.
Now there was an old woman hard
by herding cattle. “Cunning old
wretch!” said they, “she is afraid of
being buried, and is pretending to be
somebody else.” So they got hold of

Phâre besùr bâkor-bâreau²³
thângnânai bîbânkhô dinnânai
hâkhor zaunânai bûrùikhô fopnù
lâgi naibâ, manekhai, bûrùi-khô
nâmaibainaise. Sûrbâ bûrùi sâse
khâthi-au-nù mai nebai thâdangman.
Bîkhônù nunânai bîsùr railainaise
“Bâmun bûrùîâ buddigrang fop-
zânù gînânai, beaunù mai nebai thâ-
thî-dang,” hannânai bîkhô homnânai
lângnânai fopnânai dinnânai
fainaise. Bînî unau Bâmunâ monau
bîsùrkhô gînânai bûthâtnù lâgi mon
khâmnânai bîsùrnù khithânaise
“Gâthâfùr, dinî zangfùr simlifâng
gederkhô dân-hùi-nù nânggô,”
hannânai, ruâ lânânai simlîfâng ni
guriau thânglainaise. Thâng-nânai
ruâ zang bongfâng khô sâui sâui
bongfâng gaglai-sî gaglai-sî zâbâ,
Bâmunâ bîsurkhô bungnaise
“Bongfâng gaglai-sî-sù gau-gan,
nang-sùr boibù hom-thânu nânggô.”
Khithânânai Bâmunâ saunânai
hùnaise. Unau bongfâng gaglai-sin-
nânai sâsnî âbrâ thoinaise. Zapbai!

her, and, in spite of her struggles,
buried her.

And the Brahmin, in fear of what
they might do next, began to
contrive means to get rid of them.
So he said “Today, my sons, we will
go and cut down the great *simul*
tree.” So they took their axes and,
going to the *simul* tree, began
hewing with a will, and when the
tree was tottering to its fall, the
Brahmin said to them “If the tree
falls down, it will be broken. Run
under it and catch it!” And when
they did so, the Brahmin gave the
last strokes, and the tree fell on the
seven simpletons and killed them.
And that’s all!

Khânâ khuzâ nî khorâng.

Sânùi khânâ khuzâ zang phisikhî
man. Phâre bîsùr sânse railainaise
“Zang-fùr mâlâi-nî gâmiau bîbaibâ
zang-nî gâmî-nî-khrî bângsin
mangan.” Hanlainânai khuzaiâ
khânâkhô lauthiau homnânai,
bùlângnaise. Thânguì thânguì nâmâ
gezerau dîdung sorûi manse gâ-
fnâng-nânai phisikhî-nû khithânaise
“Sikhî, be lai mâ, herâ? Mâbâ galâu
zibô baidi gâfnângdang.” Khuzâiâ
bungnaise “Be hâthî khânai dîdung
sorûi.” Hanbâ, khanâiâ, “Obâ bekhô
lâ, herâ, sikhî”; hannânai bungnaise,
Khintu bî lâe-khai “Ângnù
dîkhângnânûi hu;” hannânai,
khânaia dîdung-khô lânâise.

Phâre bînîfrai thânguì dûisâ manse
man-hûi-nî-au bîtlângbâ khûsûng
mâse khânâiâ gâfnâng-naise, ârù
bungnaise “Sikhî, ne ne! Âng mâbâ
mâse gâfnângdang.” Hanbâ, khuzâiâ
“Onthai-frâ-khô-nù mâtthù bungbai
thâiù, herâ, sikhî, nang-lâi?”
Khânâiâ bungnaise “Nonggâ,
nonggâ, sikhî, nang gùgrûmnai.”

The Story of the Blind Man and the Hunchback.

There sprang up a friendship
between a blind man and a
hunchback. And one day they said
to one another “We shall get more if
we beg in some other village than
our own.” The hunchback made the
blind man hold his stick, and so
dragged him along. And as they
went, the blind man trod upon an
old elephant rope which lay upon
the road, and said to his friend “Ah!
friend, what is this thing like a long
snake which I am treading upon?”
The hunchback said “Why, it is only
an old elephant-rope.” But the blind
man said “Take it, my friend, take
it.” But, as the hunchback refused,
the blind man bid his friend hand it
to him, and so they went their ways
thence.

And presently they came to a river;
and as they were wading across it,
the blind man trod upon a tortoise
and told his friend that he had trod
upon something living; but the
hunchback said it was only a stone,
and asked what was the use of
standing there talking. But the blind
man begged him to feel and see.

Hanbâ bî gùgrùmnânai khusum-khô mannânai, khânâ-nù khithâbâ, bungnaise “O sikhî, obâ bekhô lâ herâ: zangfurnù bekhô nânggan.” Khuzaiâ “Ilit ilit lâiâ, herâ” han-nai-khai, khânâiâ bîkhô-bù gagai-nù lânaise. Bînîfrai bibaidî-nù thângui thângui dâpse-au dol dâmnai khnânânai khânaiâ khuzânâi sùngnaise “Sikhî bî dolâ-lai sùr thù? Mau thù dâmdang, herâ?” Hanbâ khuzaiâ khithânaise; Beaunù sùrbâ gurkhiâ gâthâfùr dâmdang” hanbâ, khânâiâ bîkhô lânù lâgi thin-naise.

Khintù bî, “âng mâbrùi lâbogan? Bîsùr-khô âng bùlù hâiâ zâgan, manâthù bîsur gabâng dang,” hanbâ, khânâiâ manse buddhi khâmnânai phisikhî-nù khithanaise “Sikhî, nang hâgrâ sing sing thâng-khmâ-nanai, bîsùr nî khâthî manbâ, mosâ baidî sùgùmnânai hù! Obânù bîsùr gînanai khâtgan,” hanbâ, bîbaidî-nù khuzâiâ khâmnai-au, gâthâ-frâ gînanai dol khô zrâpziprâp gâr-lâng-bâ, khuzâiâ dol khô lâbonanai khânânù hơ-hù-naise. Obasù bînîfrai sânnù zang hâgrâ gezer gezer thângui thângui nâ nunanai, khuzâiâ bungnaise “Sikhî, dâ sâ hâpbai, manâ faibai, Dâlai ârù mầu thâng-bâu-nù? Beau-nù nâ danga.

And when the hunchback announced that it was a tortoise, the blind man begged his friend to take that, too; and on the hunchback declaring that it was too heavy, he finally carried it himself.

Then they went their ways and came to a meadow, and heard a drum being beaten. And the blind man asked what that was, and where the drumming was going on. On which the hunchback said it was only cowherds drumming. On which the blind man was for sending the hunchback to fetch the drum.

But the hunchback said “How shall I fetch it? They will be too strong for me, for they are many.” Then the blind man devised a plan, and bade the hunchback crawl through the jungle and roar like a tiger. Which the hunchback did; and the cowherd boys, on hearing his roaring, ran away headlong and left the drum, which the hunchback gave, as before, to the blind man to carry.

Then the friends went through the forest, until they came to some houses. On which the hunchback said “My friend, the sun has set, and evening has come. How much further are we to go? Here are

Zangfùr beau-nù thâ-dù-nî,” hanbâ, khânâiâ bungnaise “Hagra gezernî nâkhô âng gabâng gahâm man-srâiâ, herâ, sikhî,” hannânai mâ mâ nâ dang gahâmùì nainù thimbâ khuzâiâ khithânâise “Nâiâ gâng-ne gâng-thâm. Bândâr bù gong-se dang,” hanbâ khânâiâ “Bî bândârau-nù thâgan,” hannânai, phisikhî-nù khithâbâ, bândâr-sing-hà bûlângnaise, ârù dor-fur-khô gahâmùì khâ-fthâ-nù thinnânai, beaunù thânaise. Unau beau thânai Râikhô-frâ fainânai, bungnaise—

“Zùsâ zùsâ manâmdang;
“Zânù zânù lubuidang.”²⁴

hannânai, nâ gong frùm-bù namâi-giding-bai-bâ, khânâiâ rai-dau-hot-naise “Âng beaunù dâng.” Hanbâ, raikhoâ bungnaise “Nang lai sùr?” Khânâ bù bungnaise “Nang lai sùr?” Raikho khithânâise “Âng Raikhô!” Khânâiâ bungnaise “Âng Zâkhô! Bebaîdînù be-sùr brâp-lai-naise Unâu khânâiâ bung-naise “Brâp-nù bù nânggâ, munù bù nânggâ Nangkhô bù âng nuâkhùi, ângkhô bù nang nuâkhùi. Bînîkhai manse buddi khâmbâ, zanghâ gahâm zâgan,” hannânai khânâiâ raikhônî khenai bîhot-bâ, Raikhoâ gaigainî khù-mùn daise phunânai khithîhot-

houses, let’s stop here.” But the blind man said he did not think very well of houses in the jungle, and sent his friend to have a good look at them.

Presently the hunchback returned and said “There are two or three houses and a granary.” On this, the blind man decided that they would stay in the granary, and so was dragged into the granary, where they carefully fastened the doors and prepared to stay for the night. And while they were there, Rakshashas came and said—

“Fine rice, fine rice, I can smell;
“And better things to eat as well.”

And while they were gliding round the house, the blind man shouted loudly “Here am I!” “Who are you?” said the Rakshashas. “Who are you?” shouted the blind man. “I am a Rakshasha,” said one of them. “And I am a Zakshasha!”²⁸ said the blind man. Whereupon they all got very angry. Then the blind man said “You need not get angry and you need not get noisy. I can’t see you and you can’t see me. Let us make an expedient by which you can be satisfied.” So saying, the blind man bade the Rakshasha show him a lock of his hair. On this a Rakshasha

naise. Obâsù khânâiâ bungnaise
“Dâniâ ângnî khenai-khô nai.”
Hannânai, hâthî dîdung khô dĩ-
honnânai hùnaise. Bîkhô nunânai
Raikhoâ gîkhrongbâ, khânâiâ ârù
themâ bî-hot-naise Raikhoâ bù
gaigainî themâ khô khithî-hot-bâ, bî
khusung khô khithî-hot-naise. Obâsù
Raikhoâ be Zâkhoâ-nù nunggô
nungnânai, gî-sin-bai. Khanâiâ ârù
bînî udui dâmnù thinnânai, dâmbâ,
bungnâise, “Dindù dindù hâmbai,
âng khnâbai. Dâniâ ângnî khô
khnâsong!” hannânai, dol khô dùm
dùm dâmnânai hùbâ, Raikhofrâ
gînanai, khât-thro-lâng-naise.

Unao, khânâiâ phisikhîkhô
bungnaise “Sikhî mâ mâ gahâm
bastù dang, bifurkhô khâ ârù nang
bâse, ângnù bù bâse hù, ârù mâmbâr
thângdù-nî thù” hannânai bîsùr
bînîfrai mâmbâr failainaise. Ârù
dâpse gazân thâni-au thângnânai
khuzâiâ be bastufarkhô rân-nù
nâmainânai rânnaise, Rân-khângbâ
khânâ-khô bungnaise “Sikhî
nangthâng bobekhô lâiu lâ,” Hanbâ
bî dângnainanânai khuzâ thing-nî
bhâgù-khô bângsin man-dâng-nânai,

tore out a bunch of hair and showed
it to him. On which the blind man
said “Now see mine!” And so
saying, thrust out of a chink the
elephant rope. And on seeing it, the
Rakshasha became very afraid.
Then the blind man demanded to
see a flea (from his body). And
when the Rakshasha had shown him
one, the blind man put forth his
tortoise. Then the Rakshasha
thought “This must indeed be a
Zakshasha,” and was greatly afraid.
Then the blind man bade him beat
his breast. And, on his doing so,
cried “Well done, well done! I have
heard you. Now hear me!” and
straightway began to beat his drum
“rub-a-dub-dub.” On which the
Rakshashas were greatly frightened
and ran right away.

Then the blind man said to his
friend “Take any good things that
there are, and tie them up. You take
some and give me some, and let us
go;” and, so saying, they went away
together. And when they were come
to a far place, the hunchback began
dividing the spoil. And, when that
was done, he bade his friend take
which share he would. But the blind
man groped about and found that
the share nearest to the hunchback
was the biggest. So the hunchback

rânnâiâ hâmbâ khùise hannânai,
golaigothai khâmbaise. Phâre
khuzâiâ “Nang-thâng-lai nuâ-labâ
mâbrùi mithînai, herâ? Khonle
khonle rânñu gnâng khâm-hùiù!”
Hannânai ârù rân-phâphînâ, obâbù
bângsin man-dâng-nânai, ârù
“Hamâ-khùise, hamâ-khùise,”
hannânai golai-go-thai khâmbaise.
Bîbaidî nù khonbrùi khon-bâ
khâmbâ khuzâiâ brâpnânai, âkhâiau
bâli lânânai “Nanglai gomâ khânâ
nâ misâ khânâ lùì?” hannânai
gahâmùinù megonau bâlizang
hùnânai hùnaise. Ârù obânù bî
nunai zânâise. Ârù bî bù brâpnânai;
“nunglai” mâ sâbâ dângâ lùì, nunù
hâmbâ hannânai godo-au zo-sin-
nânai lânânai, khuzâ bikhung-au
gomâgom sobai thâbâ bîbù gahâm
zânâise. Unau sâñu zang gahâm zâ-
lai-nâise, ârù bastù-fùr-khô gahâmùì
rânlainânai, nâ-i-au thâng-lai-naise.
Zapbai!

said “How did you, without seeing,
find that out? Now I have got to
divide it all over again!” So he made
a fresh division.

And the same thing happened again,
and the blind man turned everything
topsy-turvy. And, when this had
occurred four or five times, the
hunchback became angry, and
taking sand in his hand rubbed it
into the blind man’s eyes, saying
“Now we shall see if you are really
blind or not;” whereby the blind
man recovered his sight. But he, too,
was angry and said “What a hideous
thing you are, and hateful to look
upon.” And he jumped on the
hunchback’s back and belaboured
his hump till he made him straight
and well. And when the two were
hale and well, they divided their
spoil fairly and went home happily.
And that’s all!

Sâse âbrâ brai nî khorâng.

Brai bùrùi dangman. Braiâ hâgrâ
gezerau dubli dotse lânânai hâbâ
maubai thâdangman. Phâre sâñse
shikâri sâse hâgrâiau mùì gaunânai

The Story of a silly old man.

There was an old man and his wife.
One day, when the old man was
clearing jungle, a half-dead deer that
had been shot by a huntsman, came

thoi-frâm-nânai khârùi khârùi brainî
dubli gezer thing thângdangman.
Beaunù braiâ nunânai bîkhô khudâl
zang khârâ-au-nù denânai mùikhô
bùthâtnaise. Buthâtnânai hâgrâ
singau hakhmânânai dinnaise.
Emphâre unau mùi gaunai girimaia
khîthù khîthù thoi sirîlângnai naie
naie nâmai-lânguì-lânguì brainî
dubliaunù sin gamânaise. Obâsù
braikhô sùngnaise: “Helùi brai!
Nang bething mùi mâse fainai nunâi
nâ?” Braiâ bungnaise “Ânghâ dublî-
nî shimâiâ khùlâthing boinîfrai
sâthing boinîfrai” hannânai bungbâ
bî bungnaise “Nonggâ nonggâ! âng
mùinî khorâng-sù nang-nî-au
sùngdang,” Braiâ khithânaise
“Zânun! be dubliau mai zâiù nâ zâiâ
âng khîthânù hâiâ.” “Nangga-lùi,
brai, bî khorâng-khô âng
sùngâkhuì.” Brai bungnaise “Dâ
sânzôfûbai, ânghâ mikhâm ukhui-
sù-dang. Âng thâng-nù-sùi;”
hannânai, nâiau khâtlângnaise.
Obâsù unau braiâ mikhâm dùì
zâkhângnânai bùrùi-khô bungnaise;
Bùrùi, âng-nù gâbun phungau-nù
mikhâm songnânai hù. Ang mùi
mâse buthâtnânai zangnî dubliau
dinbùdang. Bîkhô mâmâr gadânù
nânggô.” Obâsù okhâ naibâ, bùrùi
mâmâr khâm dùì brainù hùnânai
bîkhô hogârnaise. Bî dubliau
thângnânai mùikhô gadânânai
rânnaise. Aglâ gaigai-nî bhâgù

limping that way and crossed the
old man’s field. On which the old
man killed it by hitting it on the
head with his hoe, and hid it away in
the jungle. Presently, the man who
shot the deer made his appearance,
having tracked its blood as far as the
old man’s field. “Here, old man!”
said he, “have you seen a wounded
deer pass this way?” The old man
replied “The boundaries of my
field? Well, the east boundary is
here and the west over there!” But
the other said “Not so, not so, I am
asking about a wounded deer.” To
which the old man replied “I know
what you mean; but whether it will
be a good crop or not, how shall I
say?” “Not so, not so,” said the
other; that isn’t what I want to
know.” But the old man said “I
cannot stop any longer. The dark is
falling, and I am hungry for my
supper. I’m off.” So saying, he went
away home, and when he had had
his supper, he said to his old woman
“You must give me my breakfast
early tomorrow, for I have killed a
deer, and I must go early and cut it
up.” So the old woman gave him his
breakfast very early and sent him
about his business. And he went to
his field, and, having chopped up
the carcass began dividing the
pieces. And first he put apart his
own share, “One piece for washing

khâmnaise. “Phânse mùkhâng sunai-nî, phânse thânkhu zânai-nî, phânse dubliâu mosô hùlângnai-nî, phânse hâli oinai-nî.” Beбайдінù huâfùrhâ zese hâbâ dang, gâsenù bhâgù khâm-thrâ-naise. Dâ unau bûrùi-nî bhâgù khâmdang “Phânse mukhâng sunai-nî, phânse thânkù zânai-nî, phânse khundung lùnainî, phanse khun pheretnai-nî, phânse hî dânai-nî, phânse khâm songnai-nî, phânse dùl lainai-nî.” Bibайдінù bînî bù zese hâbâ dang, esenù bhâgù khâmnânai sân-naise. Sânnânai bûrùi nî bhâgùâ bângsin mannaise. Obâsù braiâ brâp-nânai. “Ângsù bûrùinîkhrî hâbâ bângai bùâ mau-ù nâ? hannâ-nai, golaigothai khâmnânai, ârù rân-phâphin-naise. Dânîâ âglâ bûrùinù bhâgù khâmgrunai, ârù unau bînî bhâgù khâm-nai. Dâbîhâ bângsin zânaise. Theobù braiâ bîâu mon phatiâ khùise. Bîбайдінù bî golai-gothai khâmùì khâmùì rânâbù hamân zâiâ. Bîбайдінù sânse mâni zânaikhai, bûrùiâ; “Brâiâ-lai mâ khâm-khù?” hannânai, dhinkî thorâ manse lânanai, dubliâu thângnânai, brai-khò-nuhùi-dang, gaigainù bidot zang nânglaibâ thâdang. Bîdot-frâ-bù khonle khonle dâng-phlebai thânaikhai, gebletheble zâlângbai. Obâsù bûrùiâ dhinkî thorâ zang srî srî khîthû-au khubui-hot-bâ, braiâ mâtâ imfu hotbai hannânai, bîdot-

my face in the morning; one piece for chewing tobacco; one piece for driving the cattle afield; one piece for ploughing”; and so on, for all his daily avocations. Then he made out his old woman’s share: “One piece for washing her face in the morning; one piece for chewing tobacco; one piece for spinning cotton; one piece for fretting cotton; one piece for weaving cloth; one piece for cooking rice; one piece for drawing water;” and so on, with all her occupations. But, on counting up, he found that the old woman’s share was much the biggest. On which he cried angrily that it was not to be believed that a woman’s share could be bigger than his, and, mixing up all the pieces of flesh on the ground, he began a fresh division. This time he set apart the old woman’s share first, and his own afterwards. This time his share became the largest. But still he was not satisfied, and, mixing all the gobbets up again, he divided them again and again, but never got them equal. Meanwhile, the day had slipped by and evening was come. So the old woman, taking the pestle of the *dhenki*, went to look for her husband, and there she found him in the midst of the lumps of flesh, which had become covered with dust and dirt through much mixing. Then the old woman

khô gârnânai nâhâ khâtlâng-naise.
Emphâre, bûrûiâ bîdot khô hî zang
ban-nânai bânânai nâ-au lâbonânai,
songnânai, brai-zang zâ-lai-bâ, braiâ
sùngnaise “Bûrûi, belai mâ-nî
bîdot?” hanbâ, bûrûiâ khithânaise
“Âng dausâ fisâ mâse buthâtnânai,
nanghâ manâ lâng-nai-khai,
bekhônù song-dop-nânai dindang.
Nangnî bî mùi-bîdot-khô nebai
thâbâ, zangfur dâ khâm man-zâ-gla-
gauman.” Zapbai!

let fly the *dhenki* stump at his back.
On which he cried that a snake had
bitten him and ran home, on which
the old woman tied up the meat in a
cloth and carried it to her house, and
cooked some hastily for supper. And
when her husband asked where the
meat came from, she said that he
had been such a long time in
coming, that she had killed a
chicken and cooked it for him. “And
if you had stopped dividing that
deer’s flesh, we should never have
got any supper at all,” said she. And
that’s all!

Brai bûrûini khorâng.

Sâne brai bûrûi dangman. Bîsurhâ
nâ-â-bù gongne man. Phâre sikhau
sâbrûi be brai bûrûi nî nâi-au mâbâ
mâbî khaunù lâgi fainai. Faibâ brai
bûrûiâ boi sikhaurùrkhô khùikhâ²⁵
khâmnù lâgi buddi manse
khâmnânai dinnai. Zerehai gôbar-
khî ârù zùzai ârù gâzri-dùi hâsong-
se bîfùrkhô thoplâ zunânai dhinki
sâli nî mâroliau khâ-sai-nânai
dinnaise. Phâre unau manâblâ
sikhau-frâ fainânai brai bûrûinî nâ
injurau mânsùîâ srî mandang na

The Story of the four Thieves.

There was an aged couple who lived
in a pair of houses. And four thieves
used to prowl round their houses,
seeking to steal. And the old man set
to work to contrive devices to
disappoint them. And first he filled a
joint of bamboo with cowdung and
dirty water and rice-chaff, and hung
it up in the rafters of the *dhenki*-
shed. And when at nightfall the
thieves began prowling round and
listening to hear if the inmates were
asleep, the old people overheard

manâkhùi bannânai khnâsongbâ,
brai bûrùiâ bîsûrnî khorâng
khnânânai, braiâ bûrùikhô
bungnaise “Bûrùi, nang zangnî sorai
ârù gur-gâkhirâ mau dinkhù?”
Beaunù bûrùiâ bungnaise “Hâm srâ-
bai de, brai! Bîfûrkhô dhinki-sâli-
aù-nù khâ-sai-nânai dinnai zâbai.”
Be khorâng-khô sikhau-frâ
khnânânai dhinkî-sâliau thângnânai,
bîkhô man-hùi-nânai bâri-nî-frai
thâlit-lai lâbônânai rânânai
zânùlâgi zânaise. Obânù bîsûr mâtâ
manâmnai mannânai sùng-lai-naise
“Bîbù bângù mâ manâmdang? Bîbù
bângù mâ manâmdang?” Phâre
sâseâ boikhô âkhâiau lânânai
manâm-sù-naise. Obânâia mithînù
hânanai, boibô minîlaibâ, braiâ
sikhângnânai thokon-thorâ lânânai
hù-sù-bù-bâ, bîsûr khâtlângnaise.

Ârù sânse brai bûrùiâ boi sikhau-
fûrkhô fainai khnânânai brai bûrùi-
khô sùngnaise; “Zangfûr-hâ
songkhrùi thoplâ mau dinkhù?”
Obâsu bûrùiâ bungnaise “Dâsù
gahâm zâbai, brai! Songkhrùi
thoplaiâ zang udunai nâ-nî khùlâ-
fât-sî inzurau senânai dindang!
Sikhaufrâ maubâ lâng-nù hângô.”
Bîsûr railainai-fûr-khô sikhau-frâ
khnânânai inzûr dân-sî-nânai âkhai
sùnânai songkhrùi-thoplâ-khô dâng-
grùm-baibâ braiâ khâthrùi-lângô
lânânai thângnânai âkhâi dân-hùi-

them, and the old man said to his
wife “Old woman, old woman;
where have you hung up the
molasses and milk and *chira*?” And
the old woman replied “A nice
business! I have been and gone and
hung them up in the *dhenki*-shed,
where the thieves can get at them.”
And the thieves, hearing this,
slipped off to the shed, and, getting
the bamboo-joint, gathered plantain
leaves for plates, and divided the
spoil and sat down to eat. And one
of them, smelling at the stuff, said to
the others “Smells rather strong,
doesn’t it?” Then one of them took
his mess in his hand and smelled it,
and, seeing what had happened, they
all burst out laughing. Then the old
man came out with his big stick, and
the four thieves ran away. Another
day, the old man, hearing the thieves
prowling about, said to his wife
“Where have you hung the packet of
salt?” And the old woman replied
“A fine affair! I have hung it up on
south wall of our sleeping-house,
where the thieves can easily get it.”
And so one of the thieves thrust his
hand in, and began feeling about for
the bundle, on which the old man
took his knife and cut his hand. But
he only said “I can’t find it,” and
went away.

naise. Obâ bî “Âng manâ khùise” hannânai thângbâ, ârù sâse sikhauâ bîbaidînù dâng-grùm-bâ, bîkhô-bù âsî-au dân-fnâng-naise. Phâre beбайдî-nù sâse sikhau-nî khùmâ dânnai, ârù sâse-nî gonthong dân-fnâng-naise.

Phâre unau bîsùr gârai gahâm man-nu lâgi dùi nâmai-bai-nai-e-aù sethlau-nù thâlit khârùi sâmnai megongdù-au dùi mannânai âkhai hù-sùm-naise. Beaunù bângsin âlunai manbâbù, lùgù-nî mânsùifùr-nù khithâilâbâ “Gahâm manbai,” hannânai bungnaise. Beбайдînù sâbrùi-hâ-bù zâbâ, brâplainaise. Obânù braiâ nâ-nî frai onkhâtânai thokon lânânai bîsùrkhô hu-hot-naise.

Bînîfrai ârù sânsê brai-bùrùi-nî bâriau thâlit bîfong dangman, ârù bînî khâthiau phânlù bîfong fângse dangman. Beaunù bere-thinklî bâhâ lâdang. Phâre hoṛau be sikhau sâbrùiâ brai bùrùinî nâiau faibâ, braiâ bùrùi-khô sùngnaise “Bùrùi, nang zang-fùr-nî thâkâ-thinkhlî-khô mau fopnânai dinkhu?” hanbâ bùrùiâ khithânaise “Dinîbù gahâm

On which the other three felt about, and one got his finger cut, and another his ear, and the fourth his nose. Then they looked about in the yard for something to ease the pain, and the first, finding a cooking pot in which acrid plantain ashes had been steeped, plunged his hand in, and, getting more pain than before, only said “Ah! that’s good.” On which the others followed his example. And, while they were hopping about in pain, the old man came out and took his stick, and drove them away.

Another day, the old people found a wasps’ nest on a *chili* plant under a plantain tree. And when the thieves came, the old man said to his wife “Old woman, old woman, where have you put the *lota* with our money in it?” And the old woman answered “To-day’s luck is the worst of all. I have left the *lota* under the plantain tree in the garden,

zâbai, de, brai! zangnî thâka-thinkliâ
thâlit-guriau fopnânai dinnai-au-nù
thâbai. Bînî khâthi-au-nù fân-lù-
fîfâng-bù fângse dang. Dâ sikhaufrâ
manù-khî-mâ-sù!” Bekhò sikhau frâ
khnânânai, be thâlit guri-hâ
thângnânai nâmai-lai-hùi-bâ bere-
bâhâ-khò man-naise. Phare bîkhò
besùr dikhângnânai lâbobâ, bâhâiâ
gùbrùnânai berefrâ sikhau-fùr-khò
oṭbâ, besùr “Aiâ! aiâ!” hannânai,
khâtnaise, ârù braiâ thokon lânânai
hùsùnnaise.

Bînîfrai ârù sâanse braiâ thâthî dân-nù
lâgi sekhâr lânânai hâgrâiau
thângbâ, boi sikhau sâbrùi-khò
thaigrit guriau udulângbâ thânai
nunânai thaigrit bong-fângau
uthînânai thâri gnâng thaigrit
thaibrùi khânânai lâbô-nânai be
sikhau sâbrùi nî kheneau thaise
thaise khâ-khmâ-naise. Phâre unau
“Sikhau! sikhau!” hannânai braiâ
gâpzrî-khâu-bâ bîsùr srî mannânai
sikhângnânai khâtlângnaise. Khâtbâ,
zesenu khârù, esenù thaigrit fithâiâ
bikhungau dup dup bulângnaise.
Bîsùr braia khîthù khîthù fainânai
zang-fùr khò sodang nungnânai
khâre-thâng-naise. Phâre unau
gazân thângnânai zirai-hùi-bâ,
thaigrit khò nunânai gârnaise.

by the *chili* bush, and no doubt the
thieves will get it.” Hearing this, the
thieves went and disturbed the
wasps’ nest, and the wasps flew out
and stung them. And when they
cried in pain and ran away, the old
man ran after them with his stick
and beat them soundly.

Again, another day, when the old
man went out to cut reeds for his
fence, he found the four thieves
asleep under an O tree (the fruit of
which is hard and heavy), and the
old man, climbing quietly into the
tree, cut four of the fruits, with the
stalks attached, and tied them to the
thieves’ hair. Then he suddenly cried
out “Thief! thief!” And the more
they ran, the more the heavy fruit
bumped on their backs, so that they
thought the old man was running
after them and beating them. And
they ran a very long way before they
discovered their mistake, and
unloosed the fruit from their hair.

Bînîfrai ârù sânsê braiâ mai duliau
thânânai bûrùikhô fûrûngnaise
“Bûrùi, nang hoṛau sikhau faibâ
gaigainù sùngnânai, gaigainù khithâ
de, ereùi hannânai “Brai, brai hùn!
nang thurse khurui mau dindang?”
“Dhinkhî-sâliaunu maiduli-au bîfûr
khô dinnai zâbai. Dâ sikhau faibâ,
man-lâng-sî-gan dâ! Mâ khâmkhù!”

Be khorâng-khô sikhau khnânânai,
mâmâr dhinkhi saliau thângnânai
naihùibâ be dulikhô dikhângnânai
“O! beaunù thorse khurui-fûr dang
le! Ilit mâtù!” Obâsù bîsùr
khânânai bânânai lâng-lâi-naise.

Phâre unau thângùi thângùi dùisâ
gathau manse man-hùi-naise.
Beaunù bâtbâ braia; “Sîhâng sihâng
zâbai, um, um, dikhâng!” hanbâ
bîsùr “Mauhâ sùr raidang lùì.”
Khaise bungnaise, “Be duliau rainai
baidî khnâ-i-ù.” Ârù sâsê “Beau
mungbô guîâ; nangsùr erenùsù
khnâdang!” Obâsù thângùi thângùi
zâbrâ gathau mannânai, braiâ sî-
sam-bâ khithânai “Phutu-khoâ,
golâm-bundî-fur! Mânù gahâmù
dikhângâlù? Nangsùr kânâ nâ?
nunù hâiâ-khùi?” Ereau bungbâ
sikhau-frâ bikhô dùì-au gânnânai
khât-lâng-naise. Zapbai!

And, again, the old man climbed
into the mat receptacle in which the
paddy was stored; but, before doing
so, he instructed his wife to imitate
his voice and ask where the brass
plates and cups had been put; and to
answer in her own voice that they
had been put into the paddy
receptacle in the *dhenki*-shed. And
when the thieves heard all this, they
hurried to the *dhenki*-shed, and,
lifting up the paddy receptacle, said
with one accord: “My! isn’t it
heavy?” And so they tied it to poles
and carried it away on their
shoulders.

Presently, they came to a deep river,
and as they were wading across, the
old man cried “Look here! I am
getting wet, carry it higher.” On
which they said to one another
“Surely, some one spoke?” But,
thinking it was a mistake, they went
on, and came to deeper water. On
this the old man called out again
“Stupid brutes! Sons of slaves!
Can’t you see your way? I am
getting wet through.” And the
thieves were frightened, and,
dropping the old man in the water,
ran clean away. That’s all!

-
- 1 A “Bengali *ghusâ*” is said to be a blow inflicted with the fist, the thumbnail protruding between the first and second finger so as to give a scratch! ↑
- 2 = a “side” of pork. ↑
- 3 “*gadân rai-hùi-nânai*” = observing omens. ↑
- 4 Onomatopœic. ↑
- 5 Assamese. ↑
- 6 A child from whose mouth milk oozes if you squeeze its throat. ↑
- 7 The Kachári version of the “Swan-maiden.” ↑
- 8 Assamese “*páp.*” ↑
- 9 Snuffling. ↑
- 10 “Felt with its beak.” ↑
- 11 Assamese “*kapál.*” ↑
- 12 “Kumari,” the attendant nymph of the pool. ↑
- 13 The Kachári version of “Beauty and the Beast.” ↑
- 14 Goshain. ↑
- 15 The Assamese “*mat.*” ↑
- 16 “*mâ-thù,*” interrogative. ↑
- 17 ↑
- 18 Assamese ↑
- 19 About two paces. ↑
- 20 Assamese . ↑
- 21 It was not true of him that “*dígiti crepantis signa novit.*” The coincidence of sound is curious. ↑
- 22 Seven “plough” of cattle. ↑
- 23 Assamese ↑
- 24 This exactly corresponds to our own “Fee faw fum; I smell the blood of an Englishman!” and the Bengali “*Aù maù khaù, mánsher gandha paù!*” ↑
- 25 Query—Assamese “*hingsha.*” ↑

26 The hideous Kuvera, god of wealth. He was a white man with three legs and eight teeth. Apparently, the same as the Hindu Pluto; and lord of the shades as well as of wealth. ↑

27 *I.e.*, the season personified. ↑

28 A burlesque word from “*zânù*” = to eat. ↑

FOLK SONGS AND NURSERY RHYMES.

Addressed to a spoiled Child.

Derâ lù, derâ lù, Âfâ Fanzâlù.
Build house, build house, Father Fanzalu.
Dai nâng, fùdù nâng, Âfâ zuzînâng.
If trouble come, or worry come, Father will help.

To a conceited Child.

Âng gùrùng, gùrùng, Dainâ gùrùng.
I am wise, am wise, And the witch is wise.
Dau khîthù, khîthù, Ângnî khîthù.
And the bird's behind, behind, The bird's behind me.

Of Woman.

Dau-thep, dau-thep, dau golondî.
Wag-tail! wag-tail! bird with the goitre,
Hâbâ rangâ, hukhâ rangâ, fisâ bâflundî.
Work you can't, and toil you can't, bearing baby on your back.

A Nursery Rhyme.

Bongfâng dô, bongfâng dô, bongfâng nârengâ.
Beat the tree, and beat the tree, and beat the orange tree.
Fitsiu-siu firingâ; bidùi zâkhaibâ!
Chirrup, chirrup, bhimraj bird; give twenty eggs to me.

What Women sing at Weddings.

Zô sit sit, Gogorleng; Zô sit sit.
Pour, pour the beer, Gogorleng; pour the beer.
Dângnai dâgnai sit, Gogorleng; dâgnai dâgnai sit.
Pour in torrents, Gogorleng; pour in torrents, pour.

Then you substitute other festive occupations, for instance:

Goe khau khau (cut, cut the betelnut).
Zô lù lù (pass round the beer).
Khurui sù sù (wash the plates), &c., &c.

“Gogorleng” is the traditional name for the *bâru* or *bohua*, who plays the buffoon at weddings.

A Woman to her Lover.

Sô mâlîbai, sôbaî.
Come, my lover, come.
Gangâ zâliâ.
O! Ganges fisherman.
Thâkânî kheru manâbâ.
If I don't get silver earrings.
Âng-bù thângliâ.
I, too, cannot go.

In the following verses the woman substitutes other ornaments or presents:

An exchange of Compliments.

A girl sings—

Silâkhonârùi gâthâfùr,
Chinakona boys,
Moisù hùnù fai!
Come and drive buffaloes.

Boy answers (derisively)—

Hunù rangâ, munù rangâ.
I cannot drive, I cannot wive.
Ângkhô dâ ling, fai.
Don't cry to me to come.
Engkhut khârùi khùrù khùrù.
The mess of rice goes bubble-bubble.
Ângnî fâtse fùrù fùrù.
My share is but trouble trouble.
Khuru khusuli.
You've got the itch.
Bidot zâsuli.
Eater of meat.

What Women sing when the Bride is taken away.

Dâ gâpse, ai—dâ gapse.
Don't weep, dear, don't weep.
Khânu lai lêngâ.
Not to bind thee do they take thee;
Sunu lai lêngâ
Not to wound thee do they take thee;
Bângâl Simsânù lêngâ.
Not for Bengali or Bhutia do they, &c.
Ehe! hai! hùi!—
Oh! ho! ho!

The second, third and fourth lines may of course be varied *ad infinitum*.

The lament of a Mother.

Thokon strong strong.
With multitudes of clubs.
Thângdangman, âfâ Sokhai, nanglai.
Thou wentest, son Sokhai, thou.
Emfu blî blâ thângdangman, &c.
Flashing thy sword, thou wentest, &c.

Khaukhâ dumâ dumî, &c.
With great turban bound, &c.
Nang dangbâ omâ bidot zang zâdangman, &c.
Whilst thou lived'st I ate pig's flesh, &c.

and so on.

“Buffalo Girls come out to play.”

Ùi! Silakhonârùi hingzau-fùr,
Oh! Chinakona women.
Nâ gutnù fai.
Come and catch fish.
Nâ gutnù rangâbâ,
If you cannot catch fish,
Lùgùse dâlâ fai!
Don't come with us at all!

In other verses substitute “megong khânù,” or other things man and maid may do together.

A Love Song.

Âgùi Boisâgi,
O! sister wanderer,
Âng khô dâ bâsi!
Do not spurn me!
Sikhlâ sipnù hâiâbâ,
If you cannot sweep the yard,
Âng-bu sipfâgan.
I will help you sweep.

In the next verse, for the last two lines, substitute—“Dùi lainù hâiâbâ âng bù lai-fâ-gan,” and so on, with other female occupations. If a woman sings, the first line will be “Âdâ Buidâsi,” and she will select men's work, as, *e.g.*, “Hâthi hunù hâiâbâ, ângbù thâng-fâ-gan.”

A Mother-in-law scolds her Daughter-in-law.

Wâ bîzô nî gândeolâ!
On bamboo top, Oh! dragon fly,
Bîrdau, bîrdau, bîrdang,
Flutter, flutter, fly,
Bauharî godai zô zongnaiâ,
My youngest daughter-in-law's brewing beer.
Khùiram-dùiram zâdang.
Is bitter-sweet.

or

Bauhâri godai khâm songnaia sigram-zethram zâdang, &c., &c.
My youngest daughter-in-law's cooking rice is only hugger-mugger.

A Woman to her Husband.

Hî dai dai hùbâbâ,
If I weave him cloth.
Zimnù rangeâ.
He can't put it on.
Mâ huâ zang gorop-khù!
What a husband have I got!
Zangnî khâfâlâ!
Ah! my evil luck!
Sûnî khâfâlâ.
My dreadful luck.

For the first two lines substitute—

Gâmsâ dai dai hùbâ-bù.
Gânnù rangeâ.

or

Phâli dai dai hùbâ-bù.

Khaukhânù (or khâsônù) rangeâ.

Courtship.

Man says—

“Ùi bâze, ùi bâze!
Oh! sister-in-law!
Em bonânai hù.
Spread a mat for me.

Woman answers—

Nangnî hingzausù nonggâ hai!¹
I am not your wife!
Em-sù bobai-nù.
To spread a mat for you.

Substitute other occupations in subsequent verses.

A Love Song.

Dui lainaiâ sùrù man?
Who was it used to draw water?
Âgùì Banbâhi sikhlâ man.
It was the maid, my sister Banbâhi.

In following verses substitute “Mikhâm songnaiâ, megong khâwâiâ, hî dânâiâ,” &c., &c. If a woman sings, she sings “Hâthi hunaiâ sura man. Âdâ bùiðîsi zâlâman,” and goes on with male occupations.

Women’s work.

Dudugur,² dudugur, mâlâ-ùi.
Fisâ bânai-nî fâlâ-ùi.

In other verses substitute other work for “fisâ bânai-nî.”

*Reproach of Women.*³

Boisâgi, âsâgî, rả-rả,
Megong mikhâm songblâ, dùi-lau, dùi-sau!
Hoâ sâse nù-bù-lâ,
Gadau gâsi!

¹ A man speaking to a woman says “lùi” (cf. “he-lùi”); a woman speaking says “hai”, and a man, speaking to his wife or other woman with whom he is on familiar terms, says “ùi”. ↑

² “*Dudugur*” is the little drum on a handle, with a bead tied to it. The drum is shaken from side to side, and the bead beats it,—onomatopœically, “*dudugur, dudugur!*” ↑

³ Not easily to be translated word for word. But the meaning is that a woman cannot think of her work if a man passes by. ↑

TABLE OF CONTENTS

TRANSLITERATION.

PREFACE. iii

KACHÁRI FOLK-TALES AND RHYMES. 1

An accused person's statement in Assamese and Kachári. 1

Dùimâ dùisâ ni khorâng. 3

Sâse olsiâ gâthâ nê khorâng. 6

Gâthâ māmra nî khorâng. 9

Sâse phâlângi gâthâni khorâng. 11

Bîdâ bînânaunî khorâng. 15

Embu Bonglâ nî Khorâng. 19

Mùi ârù daukhâ dandâ nî khorâng. 22

Brai sâse ni khorâng. 24

Mùkhrâ ârù Sessâ nî Khorâng. 27

Khusung ârù Mùkhrâ. 32

Bâmun deâru bînî sâkor nî khorâng. 34

Âbrâ nî khorâng. 38

Sâ-snî âbrâ nî khorâng. 42

Khânâ khuzâ nî khorâng. 46

Sâse âbrâ brai nî khorâng. 50

Brai bûrûini khorâng. 52

FOLK SONGS AND NURSERY RHYMES. 56

COLOPHON

Corrections

The following corrections have been applied to the text:

Page	Source	Correction
iii , 5 , 5 , 17 , 21 , 60	[<i>Not in source</i>]	.
iv	indentical	identical
1 , 4	,	.
4	ng	Âng
5 , 5	Sri	Srî
6	hùnânâi	hùnânai
6	ol iâ	olsiâ
6	oidang- ùi	oidang-hùi
7 , 9 , 17	angnù	ângnù
7	khi-” thâ-i-ù	khithâ-i-ù
7	búnnânai	bùnnânai
7	”	[<i>Deleted</i>]
9	Bir	Bîr
12 , 20	.	[<i>Deleted</i>]
12	dihonnânai	dîhonnânai
16	dânnu	dânnù
19	dangmân	dangman
19	khâmúi	khâmùi
20	lânânâi	lânânai
22	hûnânai	hùnânai
22 , 46	korang	korâng

22	Binîkhai	Bînîkhai
24	khoráng	khorâng
26	Obânú	Obânù
26, 54	bîsúr	bîsùr
26	Obâsú	Obâsù
26	Obânû	Obânù
26	Beaunú	Beaunù
27	âgúi	âgùi
27	raukhôbú	raukhôbù
27	dúi	dùi
27	Mùkhrá	Mùkhrâ
27	Khoràng	Khorâng
27	mânsùìà	mânsùìâ
28	lui	lùi
28	lúi	lùi
28	ângnú	ângnù
28	hú	ù
28	Múkhrâ	Mùkhrâ
28	bú	bù
28	ârí	ârù
28	nu-zâ-húi-nai-sui-lâiù	nu-zâ-hùi-nai-sui-lâiù
28	ang	âng
29	múkhrâiâ	mùkhrâiâ
31	hanânai	hannânai
32	thalit	thâlit
33	húnânai	hùnânai
33	múkhrâiâ	mùkhrâiâ
34	beaunú	beaunù
35	sakhorâ	sâkhorâ
35	duluse	dùlùse

36	bifurkhô	bîfùrkhô
36	hanu	hanù
37	ângnu	ângnù
38	Abrà	Âbrâ
38	ní	nî
38	khòràng	khòrâng
38	súngnaise	sùngnaise
38	múiâ	mùiâ
40	mânsúiâ	mânsùiâ
40	âbrânú	âbrânù
40, 43	hunânai	hùnânai
44	zangfur	zangfùr
44	oinu	oinù
44	Zangfur	Zangfùr
45	gĩnânai	gĩnânai
46	Sânûi	Sânùi
46	Ângnû	Ângnù
46	thângûi	thângùi
48	bû	bù
49	Zâkhoâ-nú	Zâkhoâ-nù
49	Sikhi	Sikhî
49	bhâgú-khô	bhâgù-khô
50	hùnanai	hùnânai
50	boinifraî	boinîfrai
51	bùriù-khô	bùrùi-khô
53	mânsuiâ	mânsùiâ
53	bangnaise	bungnaise
55	sikhau-fúr-khô	sikhau-fùr-khô
55	zang-fur	zang-fùr
24	bán	ban

30	[<i>Not in source</i>]	,
59	Ágùi	Âgùi
60	he-lùî	he-lùi
61	Adâ	Âdâ
61	bânaini-nî	bânai-nî

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